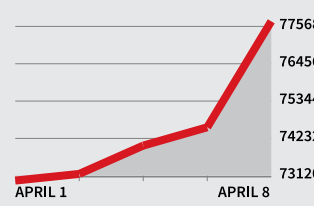


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77562.90 (+2946.32)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23997.35	+873.70
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.32	+0.81
US Dollar (in ₹)	92.58	-0.40
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	150516.00	+3322
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	244041.00	+13160

POLLSCAPE.

Opposition escalates attack on CEC; Trinamool Congress plans to move Supreme Court over voter deletions **p5**



TECHNOPHILE.

POCO X8 Pro Max offers top performance, strong battery, premium design, excellent display **p4**

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QUICKLY.

GREEN RECORD

India's solar energy capacity crosses 150 GW



Chennai: India's installed solar power capacity has crossed the 150 GW mark, numbers put out by the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy show. This happened as the installations in March reached a record 6.65 GW. In the full year 2025-26, India's solar installations stood at 44.61 GW, taking the cumulative capacity to 150.26 GW. **p11**

KHARIF PUSH

Centre hikes fertilizer subsidy by up to 21%

New Delhi: The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved the Nutrient-Based Subsidy (NBS) rates for kharif 2026 by allocating ₹41,533.81 crore, which is ₹4,317 crore higher than the expenditure of ₹37,216.15 crore in the previous kharif season. While the potash (K) subsidy has been maintained at the same level, the hike in nitrogen (N) is 10 per cent, and it is 21 per cent each in phosphorous (P) and sulphur (S). **p10**

Benchmarks skyrocket 3.8% as markets cheer Iran-US ceasefire

ON A HIGH. Tumbling crude, sharp dip in volatility and global cues trigger broad-based rally

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

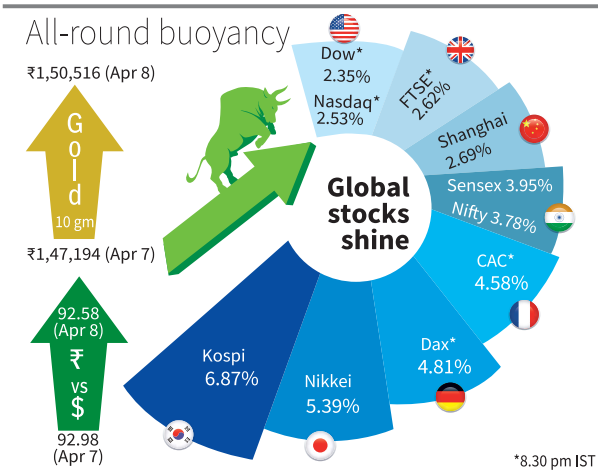
The equity benchmarks soared over 3.8 per cent on Wednesday after a last-minute ceasefire between the US and Iran triggered a global rally and sent crude oil prices tumbling.

Major equities across the globe surged 2-7 per cent, with Korea's Kospi leading the gainers pack.

The Nifty 50 closed at 23,997.35, up 873.70 points or 3.78 per cent, after opening with a gap-up of 731 points. During the day, it hit a high of 24,025.15. The Sensex settled at 77,562.90, adding 2,946 points or 3.95 per cent. The Nifty Midcap and Smallcap indices advanced over 4 per cent each.

MACRO BOOST

The sharp correction in crude oil prices delivered a broader macro dividend for India "... as it eases inflationary pressures, narrows the current account deficit, supports the rupee and strengthens fiscal dynamics," said Ajay Menon, MD and CEO, Wealth Management, Motilal Oswal Finan-



cial Services. He added that India, which had witnessed record FII outflows in March, stood to benefit meaningfully from the return of risk-on flows into emerging markets.

The two-week ceasefire, announced just hours before the US deadline, eased fears over energy supply disruptions and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

Brent crude plunged over 14 per cent, falling below \$95 per barrel, with domestic crude futures dropping nearly 17 per cent.

The Reserve Bank of India added to the positive tone,

with the Monetary Policy Committee unanimously holding the repo rate at 5.25 per cent with a neutral stance.

Sectorally, the rally was broad-based. Auto and Realty were the top performers, each gaining over 6.5 per cent, followed by banking and financial services, which advanced 5-6 per cent. The CPSE index was the lone laggard, ending marginally in the red.

The volatility gauge India VIX dropped over 20 per cent to 19.69, slipping below its 20-day EMA for the first time since February 18, sig-

nalling a meaningful easing of market uncertainty.

RUPEE RECOVERS

The rupee staged a sharp recovery, appreciating towards the 92.5/dollar zone, supported by declining crude prices and improving global cues. Gold rose over 2.4 per cent while silver surged more than 5.5 per cent.

Menon noted that with some macro stability, market focus is shifting to Q4 earnings. JM Financial estimates Nifty50 PAT growth at 4.2 per cent year-on-year for the quarter, led by IT Services, Auto, Metals, and Telecom.

India welcomes West Asia pause

India officially welcomed the announcement of a ceasefire in West Asia, expressing hope that the pause in hostilities will pave the way for "unimpeded" freedom of navigation and global flow of commerce through the Strait of Hormuz. The development is crucial for India, which depends heavily on the route for its crude oil imports and energy security.

Read more on p2

RBI's draft norms want bank boards to focus more on policy issues than daily ops

Reuters
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Wednesday proposed revised guidelines for bank boards, urging greater focus on policy matters over day-to-day operations.

In the draft rules, the RBI said bank boards will be responsible for overseeing risk management systems, strategy and key policies as well as monitoring exposure to related entities and investments in subsidiaries.

"The ultimate responsibility for the bank's performance, conduct and control rests with the board," the central bank said, adding that some matters may be delegated to sub-committees or senior management.

The move follows recent tensions at HDFC Bank, the



country's largest private lender, whose Chairman resigned abruptly, citing differences over "values and ethics".

Reuters had previously reported, citing sources, that the Chairman's involvement in operational and management matters had led to internal friction with CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan.

The review of instructions, undertaken at the request of banks, will result in boards diverting more time

to policy matters, leaving operational matters to the management, said RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra in a monetary policy speech earlier on Wednesday.

BOARD CONTROL

The draft guidelines also mandate that boards ensure adherence to corporate governance standards and clearly define matters requiring their approval or periodic review.

The proposal streamlines the RBI's earlier themes, such as financial reporting and human resources, that guided matters placed before bank boards, replacing them with a principle-based approach to sharpen focus on strategy and risk governance.

The RBI has sought public comments on the draft guidelines by May 7.

Airport charges cut 25% for three months to ease airlines' costs

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

India's airport economic regulator has mandated a 25 per cent cut in landing and parking charges for domestic flights across major airports.

The move follows a directive from the Ministry of Civil Aviation to mitigate cost pressures arising from the West Asia crisis. Accordingly, the Airport Economic Regulatory Authority mandated a 25 per cent reduction in aeronautical charges, such as landing and parking fees.

The order will remain in force for three months, after which its applicability will be reassessed. In March, *businessline* had reported that the Centre was contemplating such a move to ease pressure on the airline industry.

Also read p2

Tempers flare, stakes soar as Assam, Kerala and Puducherry head to the polls today

Our Bureau
New Delhi

As the politically charged States of Assam and Kerala and the Union Territory of Puducherry go to the polls on Thursday, prestige duels, personal feuds and an extraordinary showdown in the capital have set the stage for a dramatic day at the polling booths.

A political storm raged in Delhi after Opposition parties dubbed the Parliament presiding officers' rejection of impeachment proceedings against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar a "strangulation of democracy".

The flashpoint followed Trinamool Congress MP Derek O'Brien alleging that Gyanesh Kumar told him and fellow MPs to "get lost" when they raised concerns over the deletion of 91 lakh names from West Bengal's

electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision.

COMBAT OF HONOUR

But if Delhi saw fireworks, the Assam political theatre was at its most combustible. The contest in the tea State is framed as a prestige duel between Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, defending his Jalukbari bastion, and Congress leader Gaurav Gogoi, making a high-profile Assembly debut from Jorhat.

Equally consequential is the fallout of delimitation, which critics said had "crunched" Muslim representation by redistributing minority-heavy pockets into Hindu-dominated or reserved constituencies. Estimates suggest Muslim-majority seats have dropped from roughly 35 to about 20, reshaping electoral arithmetic in districts such as Barpeta and the Barak Valley.

A toxic sideshow sharpened tensions further.



Polling officials head to booths with materials in Kozhikode on Wednesday **K RAGESH**

Congress spokesperson Pawan Khera faced police action after alleging undisclosed foreign assets linked to Sarma's family and suggesting preparations to "flee the country" in case of defeat. Sarma responded with blistering rhetoric, branding Congress leaders as "madmen" and threatening, "Pawan Khera ka pawan peda bana doonga... usko peloonga (I will crush Pawan Khera)".

SLOW-BURNING SUSPENSE Kerala promises suspense,

the slow-burning kind decided by organisation and turnout. Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan is seeking a third straight term, while Opposition leader VD Satheesan defends his North Paravur constituency even as he leads the UDP's comeback push. Among key flashpoints is Nemom, where Minister V Sivankutty faces BJP State President

Rajeev Chandrasekhar and Congress's KS Sabarinadhan in a keen triangular fight seen as crucial to the BJP's quest for a legislative foothold. Other hotspots include Palakkad and Peravoor, where former Health Minister KK Shailaja is attempting to flip a closely fought UDP-held seat.

Puducherry, meanwhile, remains a compact sideshow shaped by shifting local alliances. As campaigning ends, Thursday's polling will test not just party strength but nerves and credibility in elections marked by drama.

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‘Found no concerns related to governance, conduct in HDFC Bank’

GIVING ASSURANCE. The banking system is very resilient; it is very safe and strong: RBI Governor Malhotra

Our Bureau
Mumbai

In the post-monetary policy press conference, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra clarified on several issues ranging from HDFC Bank, core inflation data to measures to reduce rupee volatility. Excerpts:

On HDFC Bank
We had issued a press release and I will repeat — we did not find any material concerns related to governance or conduct. We did not find anything in our supervision or in their records that had anything related to governance or conduct. Generally, in our supervision we check the minutes and we also have a record of the minutes. Only after checking all of them, we had issued a press note

On signs of stress in the banking system due to the war and transmission of rates
In so far as from the bank side, we are not seeing any systemic concerns with regard to their profitability and their health. Yes, there will be pockets, there will be sectors which will be hit because of the present crisis. The government has done a wonderful job as of now in trying to secure these inputs and



RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra

reduce the supply chain disruptions. It will all depend on how long this continues. In the meanwhile, you are aware that we have already extended the time limit from March 31 to January 30 for the longer period of exports proceeds to be repatriated to 450 days till June 30.

Against 125 basis points, about 90 basis points has been the transmission that we have seen on the lending side. Similarly, on the deposit side, it is more than 100. So, there has been good satisfactory transmission.

On disclosing core inflation data projection separately for the first time
This has been a request,

which has been there from the market participants. This has always been a factor in monetary policy decision making.
But we thought that this was the right time to give our projections on core, which we have been doing internally.
We did the five yearly review and there was a second five yearly review, which was completed. For us, it's the headline, which is the target. And we have to ensure that it's headline that remains at target and within the band. That's the goal. That's the primary goal for us. But at the same time, the various components of inflation and where they are emanating from are also very important.

On the steps taken to curb rupee volatility and depreciation
We did notice that in the last few weeks of last month, March, there was heightened volatility in the forex markets. We saw that positions were being built up, leading to arbitrage positions between the non-deliverable forward markets and the deliverable markets. In normal times, these linkages are important for an efficient price discovery.
It has been our endeavour to widen and broaden and make more liquid these markets. But when there is excessive volatility, when there is excessive building up of positions, there is only increasing volatility and perhaps not helping in price efficient price discovery, such kind of measures are taken. These are reactions to the specific market movements. These are not, in any sense, they are not signalling any structural change. We stand committed to the development, broadening and deepening of these markets to the internationalisation of the rupee. And so obviously, you know, these are not measures which are going to remain there forever.
On the recent episodes of frauds in some banks

I want to assure everyone through the media present over here that the banking system is very resilient, it is very safe, strong. The number of regulations, whether it is related to conduct, governance, prudence, liquidity, all of them, along with our supervisory framework, they keep the banking system very healthy and robust. These are episodes.
Unfortunately, these are not even bank specific, these are more in the nature of crimes. While we have to be vigilant and alert to them, the law enforcement mechanism, obviously, in our country will also take care of this.
These are entity specific developments, do not pose any systemic risk at this point in time. As we have clarified that as they play out, we deal with them on a bilateral basis as they play out.
The banking system as a whole remains resilient and we continue to focus on improving the conduct related matters and governance related matters and banks are by and large run on very professional lines. Any material supervisory concerns as and when it arises are dealt with on an event specific basis. If anything requires at a system level or a regulatory tweak, then we are not averse to taking such measures.

Gold price correction can trigger margin calls: Study

Our Bureau
Mumbai

A sharp correction in gold prices can trigger margin calls and liquidation of leveraged positions, forcing investors to sell other financial assets and imparting volatility across markets, cautioned an RBI study.
The correction can also affect portfolio allocation and market sentiment, leading to broader repricing in equities, bonds, and currencies.
“Overall, the evidence suggests that gold prices entered a significant phase of price escalation in 2025, consistent with bubble-like behaviour, with the sharp and persistent price surge pointing to pronounced market exuberance and a possible increase in underlying risks,” per the study published in the RBI's latest monetary policy report.
The study noted that gold



Gold prices entered a significant phase of price escalation in 2025

prices rose sharply since 2024, driven by escalating geopolitical tensions, a weakening US dollar and growing expectations of monetary policy easing across major economies following the end of the global tightening cycle.
SCALING NEW HIGHS
Prices underwent a sharp appreciation, increasing by more than twice within a rel-

atively short span from around \$2,060 at end-2023 to \$5,000 per ounce by February 2026 while repeatedly scaling new highs.
During this period, gold ranked among the best-performing assets globally. While part of this increase reflects strong safe-haven demand and heightened uncertainty, the pace and persistence of the rise suggest the possibility of the build-up of bubble-like dynamics during 2025.
Bubbles typically feature rapid, accelerating price surges, usually referred to as explosive behaviour, followed by sharp corrections.
“Yet, their detection remains tricky: there is no conclusive evidence that post-surge crashes are predictable, making it difficult to distinguish irrational exuberance from rational responses to changes in fundamentals that may be latent or unobserved,” the study said.

VOICES.

The RBI's decision to maintain a status quo stance, amid ongoing global uncertainties, reflects a prudent and well-calibrated approach aligned with market expectations
CHALLA SREENIVASULU SETTY,
Chairman, SBI



Preserving policy flexibility at this stage allows the central bank to assess evolving global and domestic risks while consolidating the gains from earlier easing measures
K BALASUBRAMANIAN,
India CEO & Banking Head, Citi



Plans to ease capital adequacy requirements for banks

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India on Wednesday proposed to ease banks' capital adequacy norms, including allowing greater flexibility in recognising quarterly profits as regulatory capital.
The draft amendments relate to the computation of Capital to Risk Weighted Assets Ratio (CRAR), where the RBI has proposed to remove a key restriction that currently governs the inclusion of interim profits in Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) capital.

At present, banks can include current-year profits in CET1 on a quarterly basis only if incremental provisions for non-performing assets (NPAs) in any quarter of the previous financial year do not deviate by more than 25 per cent from the average of all four quarters. The RBI has now proposed to do away with this qualifying condition, effectively making it easier for banks to count quarterly profits towards capital adequacy.
The move is expected to provide banks greater headroom in maintaining regulatory capital ratios, particularly during periods of

earnings volatility, while also reducing operational complexity in capital computation.
IFR FRAMEWORK
In a parallel development, the central bank has also proposed changes to the Investment Fluctuation Reserve (IFR) framework, which acts as a buffer against mark-to-market losses on investment portfolios.
Under the draft norms, banks that already maintain capital charge for market risk and follow revised investment valuation norms may be exempted from maintaining IFR. Additionally, the re-

quirement to maintain IFR on a continuous basis may be relaxed, with banks instead required to meet the threshold only at balance sheet dates.
The RBI said the review takes into account operational challenges faced by banks in maintaining IFR levels at all times, as well as differences in prudential frameworks across bank categories. The proposals also seek to harmonise IFR-related guidelines and remove inconsistencies.
Comments on both sets of draft directions have been invited from stakeholders until April 29, 2026.

Onboarding process for MSMEs on TReDS to be simplified

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank has proposed to drop the due diligence requirement for MSMEs to onboard TReDS platforms to promote ease of doing business for micro, small and medium enterprises. The Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) refers to a system

for facilitating financing of trade receivables. It is a technology platform on a digital or electronic network for facilitating factoring of trade receivables through multiple financiers.
The TReDS platform will bring participants together for facilitating uploading, accepting, discounting, and settlement of the invoices/bills of sellers, according to draft directions for “Trade

Receivables Discounting System’, on which the central bank has invited comments by May 1.
It will also put in place a suitable mechanism to ensure the genuineness of the uploaded invoices/bills, it added. “The platform shall ensure efficient and seamless settlement of transactions between financier and seller for financing of trade receivables and between buyer and

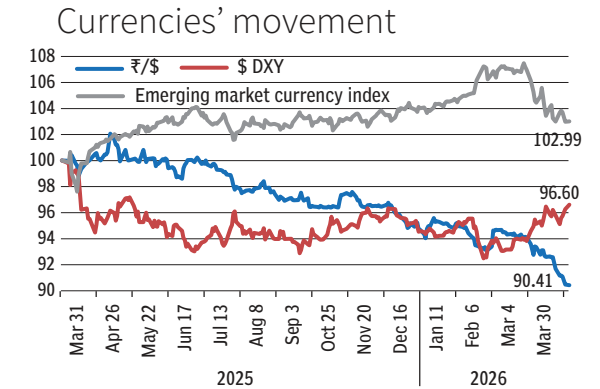
financier on the due date, using any existing payment system,” the draft said.
With a view to facilitating timely access to working capital for MSMEs, guidelines for TReDS were issued in 2014 and subsequently updated in 2018.
The scope of TReDS was further expanded in 2023 with the inclusion of insurance companies as the fourth participant.

West Asia war: RBI warns of upside risks to CAD in FY27; rupee faces continued headwinds

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Rising global uncertainties and elevated prices of key energy commodities pose some upside risks to India's current account deficit (CAD) in 2026-27, cautioned the Reserve Bank of India.
Further, the rupee faces continued headwinds from a relatively strong dollar, uncertainty about the quantum and composition of capital inflows, and rising import costs.
CAD is a measure of a country's trade where the value of the goods and services it imports exceeds the value of the products it exports.

CAD WIDENED
India's CAD widened to 1.3 per cent of GDP during Q3:2025-26 from 1.1 per cent in the corresponding period a year ago on account of higher merchandise trade deficit, while services and remittances receipts remained robust.
In the financial account,



net capital inflows fell short of CAD and resulting in depletion of forex reserves, per RBI's latest monetary policy report (MPR).
“Elevated and volatile energy prices, through higher import bill, may impact the current account deficit and exert imported inflation

pressure, including potential second-round effects. Heightened uncertainty, increasing risk aversion and safe-haven demand may lead to capital outflows thereby exerting sustained depreciation pressure on the exchange rate,” warned the report.

Term money market opened to non-banks, firms

Reuters
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India said on Wednesday it will allow financial institutions, corporates and non-banking financial companies to access the term money market.
Analysts said the move could boost liquidity and improve pricing of short-term borrowings across tenures, but may hurt mutual funds.
Currently, only banks and standalone primary dealers can trade in the uncollateralised market, where funds are borrowed and lent for 15 days to one year. The RBI did not say when the new rules will take effect.
“Broadening participation in the term money market will deepen financial markets, enhance systemic efficiency, and strengthen overall financial stability,” Ajay Kumar Srivastava, MD and CEO at Indian Overseas Bank, said.
The central bank will also raise borrowing limits for standalone primary dealers and outline a framework for the changes soon, it said.

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POSTAL BALLOT NOTICE

(Pursuant to Section 110 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014)

Members are hereby informed that pursuant to Section 110 read with Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 (“**the Act**”) and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Act and Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 (“**Rules**”), Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosures Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (“**SEBI Listing Regulations**”) and the Secretarial Standards on General Meetings issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India (“**SS-2**”), as amended from time to time, read with the General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, the latest being general circular no.03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (“**MCA**”) (hereinafter collectively referred to as “**MCA Circulars**”) and any other applicable laws, rules and regulations (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof, for the time being in force), that the following resolutions be passed through postal ballot (**the “Postal Ballot”**) only by way of voting through electronic means (“**remote e-voting**”):

Sl. No.	Particulars of Resolution	Type of Resolution
1.	Approve Material Related Party Transaction involving investment in the Equity Share Capital of Bosch Chassis Systems India Private Limited (RBIC).	Ordinary
2.	Approve Issue of 1,230 Equity Shares each on Preferential Basis for consideration other than cash to Robert Bosch Investment Nederland B.V. (RBN), Netherlands and Robert Bosch LLC, USA (Promoter Group) and approving terms thereof.	Special

All members are hereby informed that:

- The Postal Ballot Notice is being sent only through electronic mode to those Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company/Depositories. The communication of assent (FOR) or dissent (AGAINST) of the Members would take place only through the remote e-voting system facilitated by Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL).
- The postal ballot notice shall also be available on the Company's website www.bosch.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e., BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively and in the website of CDSL at www.evotingindia.com.
- In compliance of the provisions of Section 108 of Companies Act, 2013 read with Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, and Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosures Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company is providing only remote e-voting facility to the shareholders to cast their vote by electronic means on resolution set forth in the Postal Ballot Notice. Physical copies of this Postal Ballot Notice along with postal ballot forms and prepaid business reply envelopes are not being sent to members for this Postal Ballot.
- The Company has engaged the services of CDSL for the purpose of providing remote e-voting facility to all its shareholders.
- The members may please note the following:

Date of completion of dispatch of notice	Wednesday, April 8, 2026
Commencement of remote e- voting period	Thursday, April 9, 2026, at 09.00 hrs. (IST).
End of remote e-voting period	Friday, May 8, 2026, at 17.00 hrs. (IST).

- Members are requested to cast their vote through e-voting not later than Friday, May 8, 2026, at 17.00 hrs. (IST), to be eligible for being considered, failing which it will be strictly considered that no vote has been received. The e-voting module will be disabled by CDSL upon expiry of the aforesaid period. Once the vote is cast, members will not be allowed to change it subsequently.
- The instructions on the process of e-voting for members holding shares in dematerialized and physical form as well as for members who have not registered their email addresses, have been provided in the notice.
- The Postal Ballot Notices are sent only through electronic mode to those Members whose names appear in the Register of Members or Register of Beneficial Owners as received from the Depositories as on April 3, 2026 (“Cut-off date”) and whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company/ RTA/ Depositories. In terms of MCA Circulars, members who have not registered their e-mail addresses and as a consequence could not receive the postal ballot notice may get their email addresses registered with RTA by clicking on the link https://ipostatus.integratedregistry.in/KYCRegister.aspx and following the registration process as guided thereafter. After successful submission of e-mail address, RTA will e-mail a copy of the notice along with the e-voting userID and password.
- The Board of Directors of the Company has appointed Mr. Prasanna Bedi, Practicing Company Secretary as Scrutinizer for conducting the Postal Ballot through remote e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner.
- The Scrutinizer will submit his report to the Chairman of the Company, or any person authorized by him upon completion of the scrutiny of the votes cast through remote e-voting. **The results shall be declared on or before Tuesday, May 12, 2026.** The said results along with the Scrutinizer's Report would be intimated to BSE Limited (“BSE”) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (“NSE”), where the Equity Shares of the Company are listed. The results will be displayed on notice board of the company at its registered office, also uploaded on company's website www.bosch.in and on website of CDSL www.evotingindia.com.
- In case of any queries, members may contact:
 - Mr. Rakesh Dalvi, AVP, Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL), A Wing, 25th Floor, Marathon Futurex, Mafatlal Mill Compounds, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (East), Mumbai - 400013 or send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or call toll free no. 1800 21 09911.
 - Mr. Giridhar S, General Manager, Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited, No 30 Ramana Residency, 4th Cross Sampige Road Malleswaram, Bengaluru - 560 003, Email Id - irg@integratedindia.in
 - Bosch Limited – Hosur Road, Adugodi, Bangalore - 560030. E-mail: secretarial.corp@in.bosch.com

For Bosch Limited,
Sd/-
V. Srinivasan
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
Membership No.ACS16430

Place: Bengaluru
Date: April 8, 2026

An antidote for battery anxiety

POCO X8 PRO MAX. Speed Max, battery max and gaming ready, it is one of the best looking smartphones we have seen from the stable yet

Ashwin Rajagopalan

The choice of a high-performance automotive testing centre and racetrack in Coimbatore for the first reveal of POCO's performance-driven model was no coincidence. The POCO X8 Pro Max (part of a duo that also includes the X8 Pro) is billed as an 'all throttle, no brakes' smartphone that is crafted for gamers and heavy-duty users.

POCO's F Series devices have traditionally played in the flagship killer zone, while the X series served as a bridge between the more economical M Series and the more premium F Series. It's why the X8 Pro Max is a significant smartphone for POCO. It lands in a price band that's seeing a lot of action with launches from Nothing, Samsung, OnePlus and iQOO. Does the X8 Pro Max possess enough firepower in its arsenal to make an impact? The answer is a resounding yes if raw performance is what you're after.

DESIGN

The X8 Pro Max is one of the best-looking phones we've seen from the POCO stable yet. The racetrack-inspired vertical pill-shaped rear camera module makes a subtle connection with the device's promise of speed. We like the vertical lines that complement this design aesthetic. A metallic mid-frame combines with a fibreglass rear panel; it doesn't just lend a premium vibe but also adds to the resilience of the device. I didn't feel the 220-g heft, suggesting that POCO has done a great job with weight management. POCO has covered most bases on the durability front with comprehensive IP66, IP68, IP69 and IP69K ratings.

The X8 Pro Max is available in Black, Blue and White (which we checked out). There's no trademark POCO yellow in the line-up, which is a bit of a surprise. We're partial to the white colour way but the device's unique Dynamic RGB Lights play out better on the black variant. POCO has integrated dual-ringed LEDs around the camera lenses. It's a clever design ploy that doesn't just add bling but also functionality similar to Nothing's glyph interface. From charging status to music playback, the lights aug-



MIXED SHOT. POCO's X series have served as a bridge between the more economical M Series and the more premium F Series



THE HOOK. Incredible edge detection



Zoom sample



REAL WORLD READY. From daylight to daily life, the X8 Pro Max camera manages to hold its own in most scenarios ASHWIN RAJAGOPALAN



certainly not flagship class but manages to hold its own in most scenarios.

VERDICT

The POCO X8 Pro Max is positioned as a smartphone to satisfy your need for speed and it does. The stellar display and ultra-fast performance are backed by a massive battery that keeps running like an Energizer bunny. It's a great option if you're a heavy-duty user who puts a premium on performance and battery life over camera performance.

● SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹42,999 onwards
Pros: Battery life and fast charging, performance, sleek design
Cons: Lowlight camera performance, bloatware

TECH DIGEST.

Chrome unveils vertical tabs, immersive reading mode

Google is rolling two new features designed to streamline browser experience through vertical tabs and an immersive reading mode in Chrome.



Users now have the option to use vertical tabs in Chrome, depending on their preferences. Just right click on any Chrome window and select "Show Tabs Vertically." By moving your tabs to the side of your browser window, you can read full page titles and manage tab groups with ease, even when your tab count hits double digits.

This layout is perfect for multi-tasking, saving you time by making sure you never lose a tab. Reading mode, a favourite Chrome feature for deep focus, is even better with a new full-page interface. Right-click on any page and select "Open in reading mode" to remove visual distractions and transform a busy webpage into an immersive, text-focused reading experience.

Google now allows users to change their Google Account username in a few simple steps. Users can now change their Google Account username (i.e., the part before @gmail.com). The ability to change a username is available now for all Google Account users in the US.

Asus hosts 2026 community event series

ASUS recently held the first city edition of its 2026 community event series, Beyond Incredible with ASUS, in Mumbai. The event brought saw 88 creators, tech enthusiasts, students, fans and regional media for an evening focused on next-generation computing experiences.



The event featured ASUS Creator Series devices and demonstrations of the Zenbook AMD line-up. ASUS also hosted an interaction with attendees, providing an overview of the company's product strategy and ongoing community initiatives in India. The session featured interactive product walkthroughs showcasing the ProArt GoPro Edition, ProArt P16 and the ROG Zephyrus G14. Live demonstrations of creator workflows were held at the event. The event featured live demos, hands-on experiences and community-led conversations, allowing attendees to explore ASUS' technologies. The 2025 edition saw a four-city community tour across Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad and Kolkata.

Ashwin Rajagopalan

My tryst with activity and wellness tracking began in 2015. This was the year Fitbit arrived in India, and the first Gen Apple Watch made its global debut. Since then, I've tested numerous activity trackers and smartwatches.

Smart rings have gradually increased share of market and share of voice in popular culture this decade. Finnish company Oura pioneered the smart ring; the first-gen Oura ring also made its debut in 2015.

Oura has now officially arrived in India with its latest Oura 4 Ring, the company released the Oura India Sleep report during the launch to underscore the ring's sleep tracking credentials. After a couple of weeks with a (smart) ring on my finger, I feel quite committed to this relationship, but it does have its ups and downs.

DESIGN

One of the challenges for smartwatches has remained its form factor, especially if you are relying on one for sleep data. This is where an unobtrusive smart ring has a clear advantage. The Oura Ring 4 feels more like a piece of jewellery than a gadget; it can pass off for a wedding band.

After over a decade and currently in its fourth iteration, Oura has refined its design, a fine blend of function and form. Oura has flattened the domes that conceal the sensors from the previous iteration. The Ring 4 feels like any other ring on your finger.

The titanium build adds to its featherlight form. The current generation weighs about 3.3-5.2 g, depending on the size of your ring. The compact size also means that the ring is not repairable, the battery is not replaceable.

Oura's sizing kit is the first step in your purchase process; the kit allows you to zero in on the exact fit. The ring is available in a range of sizes from 4 to 15 and comes in a choice of colours, with a ₹11,000 premium for the Brushed Silver, Gold, Rose Gold and Stealth colour options. The inside of the ring conceals the sensors that measure heart rate (and heart rate variability), respiration rate and skin temperature, and the accelerometer tracks movement and activity 24/7.

Oura tells us that the Ring 4 is water resistant up to 100 m, it's suitable for sauna and water sports but not ready for your diving exped-



SMARTER WELLNESS. The Oura Ring 4 offers actionable insights and helps you cope with your everyday routines better



itions. If you're not used to wearing a ring, it's easy to remove the ring and forget about it. I removed the ring the one time I used a swimming pool and every single time I took a shower over the three weeks I tested it.

SET UP AND COMPANION APP

The Oura Ring 4 connects seamlessly via Bluetooth to your smartphone. I paired it with an iPhone; however, the companion app is available for Android smartphones.

The user interface is one of the most visually pleasing we've seen on any wellness app, with intuitive navigation paths. Oura's user experience is built around three key pillars — sleep, readiness and activity. The information is neatly arranged within three sections that include Today, Vitals and My Health.

The app doesn't just keep generating data but offers useful insights and observations about your body status.

The Readiness score, for instance almost always matched how I was feeling on any given day while sleep tracking is easily one of the best on any wearable.

Oura can share data with the Apple Watch (that I enabled) and Strava. Oura detected my gym workouts and I used the ring while doing weight training.

On a recent 15 km cycling trail in New Zealand, the Ring 4 auto-detected the entire route and connected with my iPhone to map the trail.

It also kept reading multiple fast walks (you can validate these to add to your list of activities). While some users have claimed that there are visible scratches during gym workouts, I have always used the Ring 4 with my gym gloves and it's largely unscathed.

Oura's subscription plans have fuelled constant debate, given that some of its rivals (like the Samsung Galaxy Ring) don't require a subscription to access the full suite of data. Oura's India subscription plan (₹599/month) doesn't come cheap but offers a lot of finer details that give it an edge.

BATTERY LIFE

We like the design of the charging dock. Oura claims 8 days of battery life, and it matched the results of our tests after two charging cycles. I had disabled blood oxygen monitoring, which could have resulted in an extra day of battery usage. Most users should manage about a week of battery usage that lends the Oura Ring 4 a clear edge over smartwatches in this department.

VERDICT

The Oura Ring 4 is one of the most evolved wellness wearables I've tested. It offers actionable insights and helps you cope with your everyday routines better.

Smart rings seemed to have hit a peak with the Oura Ring 4 at the very centre of this evolution. With more AI insights in the pipeline, this experience only promises to get better.

The ring's form factor allows you to truly wear it and forget about it until you check out the app for the insights you need.

I'd recommend pairing the Oura Ring 4 with a smartwatch if you're a fitness enthusiast who needs to track workouts. You don't need to wear that smartwatch all day or night. The Oura Ring 4 is probably the best smart ring right now, but the stiff price tag and recurring subscription costs make it a niche product ideal for those willing to pay a premium for wellness.

● SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹28,999 onwards
Pros: Sleep tracking, wellness insights, unobtrusive form factor, user interface of companion app
Cons: Requires a subscription fee, active users might also need a smartwatch

Opposition to step up attack on CEC over rejection of impeachment notice

BALLOT BATTLE. Trinamool Congress to move SC over voter deletions; EC meet with party delegation turns acrimonious

Our Bureau
New Delhi

On the eve of polling for the Assembly elections in Assam, Puducherry and Kerala, the Opposition decided to amplify its attack against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar as the parties jointly criticised the rejection of the notice of motion for his impeachment. They vowed to take other remedies available within the Constitution and law to ensure Kumar's accountability.

Separately, West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee stated that the Trinamool Congress (TMC) would move the Supreme Court if valid voters' names deleted during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) were not restored.

Rajya Sabha Chairman CP Radhakrishnan and Lok

Sabha Speaker Om Birla rejected the notice of motion brought by 300 Opposition MPs from 20 parties and independent parliamentarians to remove Kumar.

Addressing the media on behalf of the Opposition in the national capital, senior Congress leader Abhishek Manu Singhvi charged that the Parliament decision undermined Constitutional processes and weaken accountability in a democracy.

The rejection at the preliminary stage amounted to "strangling" the entire impeachment mechanism envisaged in the Constitution. He did not disclose the future course of action, but stated that remedies permissible within the Constitution and law will be exhausted.

BENGAL VOTERS Meanwhile, the TMC upped the ante parliamg Bengal



LAST-DITCH EFFORT. People wait to submit petitions before the Special Tribunal after their names were deleted from the SIR final list in West Bengal's Dakshin Dinajpur district on Wednesday

losing 12 per cent of the electorate since October due to the SIR. However, 27 lakh voters' deletion from the electoral roll is now under adjudication.

About 91 lakh voters were dropped from the electoral rolls, with most of them being in the Muslim-domin-

ated districts of Murshidabad, North 24 Parganas and Malda.

UNRESOLVED CASES Addressing a rally after filing her nomination from the Bhabanipur constituency, CM Mamata Banerjee said while 32 lakh names had

been restored following court intervention, a large number of cases remained unresolved. She claimed that 27.6 lakh voters were still under adjudication, and warned that many could be deprived of their franchise if corrective steps were not taken. "Everyone should have the right to vote. If names are not restored, we will go to court again," she said.

The issue of voter list revision also figured in a tense meeting between a TMC delegation and the full-bench of the Election Commission of India, which ended on a bitter note, with both sides trading allegations over each other's conduct.

The TMC delegation, led by Rajya Sabha MP Derek O'Brien and comprising deputy leader Sagarika Ghose, MPs Saket Gokhale and Menaka Guruswamy, said the seven-minute interaction with Kumar turned

acrimonious, alleging that the CEC asked them to "get lost" after they raised concerns and submitted nine letters from Mamata Banerjee. They highlighted to Kumar alleged irregularities and links between some poll officials and the BJP.

"We asked the CEC how he can ensure the conduct of free and fair elections when such tainted officers are being appointed in Bengal. To this, his answer was 'get lost'," O'Brien told reporters. "We told the CEC we would not listen to him because he does not allow his colleagues to speak. We have attended eight to nine meetings like this, where none other than the CEC speaks," said O'Brien.

Election Commission sources rejected the charge and accused the TMC delegation of "shouting" during the meeting, describing the exchange as "straight talk".



QUICKLY.

EC seeks removal of political ads from online platforms and channels

Thiruvananthapuram: The EC on Wednesday noted that political advertisements were appearing on channels and online platforms on the eve of the April 9 Kerala Assembly polls and sought that they be removed immediately. The instruction was circulated by the EC's Kerala office in an official WhatsApp group, comprising media groups and journalists.

"Advertisements are appearing on channels and online platforms. This is not permitted during the silence period. It is requested that these be withdrawn immediately," the message said. According to the EC, campaigning through public meetings, rallies, media interactions and election-related interviews was strictly prohibited during the silence period to ensure a level playing field for all stakeholders. It also directed that no person shall display to the public any election matter by means of cinematograph, television or other similar apparatus, including radio, during the 48 hours ending with the conclusion of the polls. 𑍻𑍻

A day before Assam polls, candidate quits Congress

MEET THE CANDIDATE

A technologist who aims to make Tenkasi 'Silicon Valley of India'

Rohan Das
Chennai

When Ananthan Ayyasamy returned to his hometown in Tenkasi in south Tamil Nadu after more than two decades in the US, his mission was clear — to offer youngsters in the city all that he missed out on while growing up in the region.

Contesting the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly polls as a BJP candidate from Tenkasi district's Vasudevanallur constituency, his poll promise is to transform the district — situated in the foothills of the Western Ghats — into the 'Silicon Valley of India' and 'Estonia of Asia'.

"About 30 per cent of Tenkasi's population is in agriculture-related jobs that produce low wages and income. Of the 15 lakh population here, nearly 3 lakh are women who depend on beedi rolling for their livelihood. There are only about 10,000 jobs that are in the organised sector," he told *businessline*.

"Our mission is to create 1 lakh hi-tech jobs in the district and attract industries to Tenkasi to reduce migration to cities such as Chennai and Bengaluru," he said.

He added that the goal is not just to create organised sector jobs but also help entrepreneurs so that they can create innovations. The mission has already been kick-started, said Ayyasamy.

In collaboration with fellow Tenkasian Sridhar Vembu, he launched a semiconductor design venture called Tenkasi Semiconductors (TENSEMI), which is currently working on chip design for edge AI computing and network applications. The initiative is expected to bring out its first chip within a year.

Tourism is another area of



focus to rejuvenate the local economy, he added.

"At least 20 lakh people visit or travel through Tenkasi for tourism every year. But there is hardly a decent hotel or a good restaurant here," he said while mentioning plans to build a theme park, multiple hotels and reconstruct dams into day picnic spots.

OUTSIDER TAG Ayyasamy firmly shuns the outsider tag in this polls, where his opponents include E Raja of the DMK and TVK's R Amutha Rani.

Recalling his childhood marred by caste violence and poverty in Tenkasi, he said his return — after working as an Engineering Director at Intel in the US — is driven by a desire to give back. "I have been living here for the last four years. I have travelled to every village in the district and taken several Central government schemes to the people," he said.

He believes the current political heads of Tenkasi have not delivered on their promises. "The people of Tenkasi district have completely been let down. The Chief Minister visited Tenkasi in November and made 10 promises for the district. This was in addition to the 13 promises that were already made in 2021. Nothing has been fulfilled," he said.

'All arrangements in place for 9.5 lakh to cast vote in Puducherry today'

Press Trust of India
Puducherry

Around 9.5 lakh voters will decide the electoral fate of 294 candidates in the Assembly elections in Puducherry on April 9, and all arrangements have been made for the smooth conduct of polls, said Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) P Jawahar here on Wednesday.

The polling will begin at 7 am in Puducherry and its enclaves of Karaikal, Mahe and Yanam, which together have 30 Assembly seats. The Union Territory has 1,099 polling stations and, of them, 209 have been identified as vulnerable, said Jawahar.

"Thirty polling stations would be managed exclusively by women staff and 15 booths would be operated by young officers. Two polling stations would be operated by persons with disabilities, he added.

NEW VOTERS The Union Territory has as many as 24,919 new voters, he said. The CEO said senior citizens and differently-abled voters would be assisted by volunteers at the booths to reach the polling stations to cast their votes and also for their safe return to their homes. Wheelchairs will be available. The election authorities have engaged 2,200 young voters to take care of them, he said.

Jawahar said deployment of drones for monitoring purposes had helped track persons indulging in activities to tarnish the fairness of the polls. He said cash and liquor were seized after drone surveillance was conducted. A total of ₹77.25 lakh was seized at various points and liquor worth ₹68.5 lakh was also seized.

Seventeen cases were booked for alleged violation of the Model Code of Conduct in the past few weeks.

VISUALLY.

Compiled by **Sourashis Banerjee** | Graphic: **Visveswaran V**

Assembly 2026: Key face-offs

Assam (2026)		
Jalukbari	Jorhat	Dhubri
Guwahati Central	Dispur	Bihpuria
Dibrugarh	Tamulpur	

Assam Assembly elections 2021	Constituency	Winner in 2021 elections	Votes received in 2021
	Jalukbari	Himanta Biswa Sarma (BJP)	1,30,762 (77.39%)
	Jorhat	Hitendra Nath Goswami (BJP)	68,321 (48.84%)
	Guwahati Central	Ramendra Narayan Kalita (AGP)	1,37,533 (59.9%)
	Dispur	Atul Bora (BJP)	1,96,043 (64%)
	Bihpuria	Amiya Kumar Bhuyan (BJP)	58,979 (48.53%)
	Dhubri	Nazrul Hoque (AIUFD)	1,23,913 (70.24%)
	Dibrugarh	Prasanta Phukan (BJP)	68,762 (60.43%)
	Tamulpur	Leho Ram Boro (UPPL)	78,818 (46.75%)

Kerala (2026)				
Dharmadam	Paravur	Nemom		
Palakkad	Aranmula	Peravoor	Thrissur	Alappuzha

Kerala Assembly elections 2021	Constituency	Winner in 2021 elections	Votes received in 2021
	Dharmadam	Pinarayi Vijayan (CPIM)	95,522 (59.61%)
	Paravur	VD Satheesan (INC)	82,264 (51.87%)
	Nemom	V Sivankutty (CPIM)	55,837 (38.24%)
	Palakkad	Shafi Parambil (INC)	54,079 (38.06%)
	Aranmula	Veena George (CPIM)	74,950 (46.30%)
	Peravoor	Sunny Joseph (INC)	66,706 (46.93%)
	Thrissur	P Balachandran (CPI)	44,263 (34.25%)
	Alappuzha	PP Chitharanjan (CPIM)	73,412 (46.33%)

Source: ECI

'I will use my education and experience to bring about development'

bl.interview

Ravi MG
Thrissur

A young Congress candidate from Wadakkanchery in Thrissur district in Kerala is eager to repurpose the Kerala State Electronics Development Corporation Ltd (Keltron) campus, a relic of the town's industrial past, into a business development hub that could create 5,000 jobs. Thirty-eight-year-old engineer PN Vaisakh, who was the National Secretary of the Indian Youth Congress and a two-time municipal councillor,

outlined his healthcare reforms and shared his vision for a wellness ecosystem in Wadakkanchery, an urban constituency north of Thrissur.

Edited excerpts:

As one of the youngest candidates, how do you think voters will see you, compared to seasoned politicians like sitting LDF MLA Xavier Chittilappilly and NDA candidate TS Ullas Babu?

I believe I am able to connect with the people because I am young, and I vibe positively

I believe I am able to connect with the people because I am young, and I vibe positively with the Gen-Z

PN VAISAKH
Congress candidate from Wadakkanchery

with the Gen-Z. My age is one of my biggest strengths.

What do you have to say about the 'youth exodus' from Kerala for study or work?



Kerala has many opportunities that have not been streamlined properly. For example, I am an engineer who studied and trained in my State and, as a politician now, I will use my education and

experience to bring about development that will match the aspirations of youngsters.

Kerala relies heavily on the services and tourism sectors to generate employment. What are the other areas that need to be nurtured for job creation?

I am looking at start-ups, especially those in food production, and supporting them with tax incentives. One of the first things I will do, if the people give me a chance, is recast Keltron, once our flagship industrial hub that is now in a state of

neglect. I will transform it into an economic hub for IT establishments, malls and start-ups — all of which can generate up to 5,000 jobs.

Voters are tired of promises politicians make. As a candidate, what do you have to say?

Simple. If I don't perform, vote me out.

What are your plans for healthcare?

My top priorities will be to strengthen the infrastructure of the government district hospital in Wadakkanchery by adding, among other things, a bloc for sur-

gery and a special unit for paediatrics care, and set up a separate university hospital bloc within the Thrissur Medical College Hospital, something similar to AIIMS.

Wadakkanchery is 80 per cent urban, and I believe the people will appreciate the concept of wellness ecosystems. Some of the facilities will include wellness parks, yoga centres, walkways, an open gymnasium, drinking water projects, playgrounds, an indoor stadium and a children's park that will be named after Jawaharlal Nehru. A key facility will be *paghali veeadu*, a daytime haven for the elderly, to interact with like-minded

people and play indoor games.

You are taking on experienced leaders like Chittilappilly in this election. How big is the challenge?

I respect his experience. However, I am a local face in Wadakkanchery, and have reached out to the people as National Secretary of the Indian Youth Congress and a two-time municipal councillor. I have played an active role in youth mobilisation and campaign work. Importantly, I have strong support from my party's senior leaders, whose mentorship has shaped my political journey.

Cease and desist

US-Iran ceasefire, a ray of hope for the world

After 40 days of utter mayhem, the US and Iran have agreed to a two-week ceasefire — on a war that the US should not have begun in the first place. Markets have responded with a huge sense of relief, with Brent crude diving below \$100 a barrel, and Sensex/Nifty posting near 4 per cent gains. The rupee gained 0.5 per cent over Tuesday’s close on Wednesday, ending at 92.58 to the dollar.

Coming just hours after US President Donald Trump’s threats to blow up Iran, the ceasefire comes as a welcome anti-climax. Now, both sides are expected to conduct talks on the basis of an ambitious set of proposals. While it is anyone’s guess whether this truce endures, major economies and businesses have been pushed to the wall by dizzying levels of disruption and uncertainty — and that includes the US. The Trump administration is facing an economic, political and possibly global blowback. It is being increasingly perceived that China, the world’s second largest economy and the main buyer of Iranian oil, is behind the mediation efforts, even as talks are being held in Pakistan.

So far, it is apparent that Iran has had the upper hand in the conflict, despite its terrain and towns being battered. One fact alone bears this out: Iran blocked the Strait of Hormuz, open to free international access before the war, and effectively shut off 20 per cent of global oil supplies. It has eased access in recent days on its terms, but not before driving up oil prices by about \$50 a barrel over a month. Now, a somewhat defensive Trump says that the ceasefire is predicated on Iran ensuring a “complete, immediate and safe opening” of the Strait of Hormuz — which, absurdly enough, was the state of play before US and Israel wrecked it. Iran has said that the straits, for now, will be opened under military supervision, but that it cannot be restored to the pre-war position. These are negotiating postures — just as Iran has demanded war reparations, lifting of economic sanctions, an end to attacks, the release of frozen assets and a UN security resolution making a deal binding, as part of its 10 demands. The US has pushed for the dismantling of Iran’s nuclear programme as part of its 15-point agenda.

The power play is intriguingly poised, with Iran possibly having an edge. If Trump considers Iran’s proposals “workable”, it perhaps suggests that he is looking for an “off ramp” to end a war that has not achieved any of the stated objectives. This included regime change in Iran, destruction of its military, dismantling of its nuclear programme and controlling the Strait. Ironically, what was once a freely navigable strait could well turn into a tolled one if Iran has its way and that’s a definite loss of face for the US. Both, US and Israel do not seem to have reckoned with Iran’s capacity to make a success of ‘asymmetric warfare’. Going forward, the most desirable outcome of the mediated talks would be to ensure that the Strait is safe and open. Meanwhile, we can expect a geopolitical reset, to US’ detriment. India’s position vis-a-vis the US and China looks complicated now, with Pakistan’s involvement — but the economy will hopefully ease up.

POCKET RAVIKANTH



NARENDRA MODI

In the coming days, India will be immersed in a festive season, with celebrations taking place across the length and breadth of the nation. The people of Assam will mark Rongali Bihu while Odisha will celebrate Maha Bishuba Pana Sankranti. In West Bengal, Poila Boishakh will usher in the Bengali New Year and in Kerala, Vishu will be observed with immense enthusiasm. In Tamil Nadu, Puthandu will be celebrated while in Punjab and other parts of Northern India, it will be Baisakhi, which will usher in a spirit of hope as well as positivity. I convey my best wishes to all those across India and the world who are marking these festivals. May these auspicious occasions bring happiness and prosperity to everyone’s lives. Furthermore, on April 11, we will commence the 200th birth anniversary celebrations of Mahatma Phule and on the 14th, India will pay homage to Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar on Ambedkar Jayanti.

In addition to these special occasions, when the spirit of renewal fills our hearts and minds, our nation stands at the threshold of another historic occasion. It is an opportunity to deepen the foundations of our democracy and to reaffirm our collective commitment to equality and inclusion.

On April 16, Parliament will be convened to discuss and pass an important bill that advances women’s reservation. To describe this merely as a legislative exercise would be an understatement. It is a reflection of the aspirations of crores of women across India. It is an affirmation of a principle that has long guided our civilisational ethos, that society progresses when women progress.

Women constitute nearly half of India’s population. Their contributions to our nation are vast and invaluable. Today, India is witnessing remarkable achievements by women across every field. From science and technology to entrepreneurship, from sports to the armed forces and from music to the arts, women are at the forefront of India’s progress. Over the years, sustained efforts have been made to create an enabling environment for women’s empowerment. Greater access to education, improved healthcare, enhanced financial inclusion and better access to basic amenities have strengthened the foundations of women’s participation in economic and social life.

Yet, their representation in the world of politics and legislative bodies has not always been commensurate with their role in society. This is particularly unfortunate because when women



Together, let us empower our Nari Shakti

FOSTERING EQUALITY. It is imperative that the 2029 Lok Sabha elections and the Assembly elections to the various States in the coming times are conducted with women’s reservation in place

participate in administration and decision-making, they bring with them experiences and insights that enrich public discourse and improve the quality of governance.

It is imperative that the 2029 Lok Sabha elections and the Assembly elections to the various States in the coming times are conducted with women’s reservation in place. Over the decades, there have been repeated efforts to provide women with their rightful place in democratic institutions by the previous governments. Committees were made, bill drafts were introduced but they never saw the light of day. But the broad consensus has remained that women’s representation in legislative bodies has to increase. In September 2023, Parliament passed the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam with the same spirit of consensus. I consider it to be among the most special occasions of

On April 16, Parliament will be convened to discuss and pass an important bill that advances women’s reservation. To describe this merely as a legislative exercise would be an understatement

my life. This opportunity to ensure women’s reservation also resonates deeply with the spirit of our Constitution. The makers of our Constitution, notably the distinguished women members of our Constituent Assembly, envisioned a society where equality is both enshrined and realised in practice. Strengthening women’s participation in legislative institutions is an important step towards fulfilling that vision. It reflects our commitment to building a society where every citizen has an equal stake in shaping the nation’s destiny.

CANNOT BE DEFERRED This is a moment that cannot be deferred any longer. Every delay in advancing women’s representation is, in effect, a delay in strengthening the quality and inclusiveness of our democracy. For decades, the need for greater participation of women in legislative institutions has been acknowledged, discussed and reaffirmed. To postpone action now would mean extending an imbalance that we already recognise and have the capacity to correct. At a time when India is moving forward with confidence and purpose, it is essential that our institutions reflect the aspirations of all citizens, especially those who form half our population. Timely action will not only honour long-standing commitments but also ensure that the

momentum of progress is sustained. This is truly a historic opportunity to make our democracy more representative, responsive and future-ready. This moment calls for collective action. It is not about any one government, party or individual. It is about the nation as a whole recognising the importance of this step and coming together to realise it. It is what we owe to our Nari Shakti. That is why the passage of a bill for women’s reservation should reflect the broadest possible consensus and be guided by the larger national interest. Such opportunities call upon us to act not for ourselves, but for future generations. They remind us that the true strength of a democracy lies in its ability to evolve and to become more inclusive over time.

As we approach this historic Parliament sitting, I appeal to all Members of Parliament, across party lines, to come together in support of this important step for the women of India. Let us seize this opportunity with a sense of responsibility and purpose. Let us act in a manner that reflects the highest traditions of our democracy. India has always shown that when it comes to matters of national importance, it can rise above differences and act with unity. This is one such moment. Let us move forward together and strengthen Constitutional values and empower our Nari Shakti for national progress.

US-Iran ceasefire, and what it means for India

Ships will be allowed through the Strait of Hormuz. This change is expected to stabilise energy supplies and prices

bl.explainer RAMASAMY JAYAPRAKASH

In a major de-escalation in West Asia, the US and Iran have agreed to a two-week ceasefire. US President Donald Trump announced the ceasefire on Tuesday more than a month after intense hostilities broke out, leading to Iran’s blockade of the Strait of Hormuz. The blockade caused significant disruption to global energy flows and led to sharp price increases for oil and gas. Here is a breakdown of what has been agreed upon and what it means:

What has been agreed in the ceasefire deal? The ceasefire deal includes a two-week pause in the attacks and bombings by the US (and by extension, Israel) and missile strikes by Iran in the ongoing West Asian conflict, including any retaliatory actions linked to the conflict. However, Israel has stated that the ceasefire does not apply to its current offensive in Lebanon against the Hezbollah militants, despite Pakistan, which mediated the ceasefire, saying it does. Additionally, Iran has provisionally agreed to allow freight transport in the Strait of Hormuz, albeit with military supervision which comes with a ‘fee’

which would be imposed in co-ordination with Oman. The Pakistan-mediated ceasefire (China would perhaps be more accurate) is said to proceed with further diplomatic talks in Islamabad on April 10, for which Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif extended invitations to delegates from the warring nations.

What are Iran’s terms? In addition to claiming victory, Iran has stated that the war would be concluded only if the US accepts its 10-point peace proposal, many of which were earlier rejected by the US. Some of Iran’s demands from the proposal include: acceptance of Iran’s uranium enrichment programme; lifting of all primary and secondary sanctions on Iran; releasing frozen assets of Iran; full US military withdrawal from the region; immediate ceasefire on Iran and its allies; continuation of Iran’s control over the strait; and making these conditions binding through a UN Security Council resolution.

What terms is US laying down? Trump has claimed a “total and complete victory” in the war. He said the pause is subject to Iran agreeing to and honouring the “complete, immediate, and safe opening” of the Strait of Hormuz and called it a ‘double-sided ceasefire.’ He also added that US



TRUCE. Expectations of a long-lasting one

military objectives had already been met and that negotiations towards a broader, formal agreement were “very far along.” He wrote: “We received a 10-point proposal from Iran and believe it is a workable basis on which to negotiate.” Trump added that “almost all” major points of contention had been resolved. However, Trump has posted on TruthSocial that there would not be any uranium enrichment in Iran and the US would work with Iran to “dig up and remove” the deeply buried nuclear dust.

Will ships be allowed to pass through the Strait of Hormuz now? Ships will be allowed to pass. The US has said it would help clear the massive backlog of shipping traffic that accumulated during the blockade. Reports from the region suggest ships

are already preparing to resume operations as the blockade has essentially ended, for the time being. However, Iran has declared that traffic would be allowed with its military supervision along with a ‘fee’, which some reports claim could go up to \$2 million per ship. Iran has indicated that it would be split with Oman and would be used to fund reconstruction of damaged infrastructure.

What will the impact on India be? The ceasefire comes as a massive relief to India as India imports over 60 per cent of its LPG and about 90 per cent of it traverse through the Strait of Hormuz. Additionally, 30 per cent of India’s crude and 47 per cent of natural gas comes via the narrow strait. The month-long blockade put a significant strain in the domestic supply of LPG, forcing price hikes and securing supply from more diverse and expensive sources for now. According to ICRA, “The announcement of ceasefire provides much needed relief to the domestic oil and gas sector. While crude and product flows may take months to normalise, some supplies would start for crude oil and petroleum products like naphtha, LPG, thereby alleviating the immediate shortage.”

With inputs from Rishi Ranjan Kala

LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Milestone at Kalpakkam This refers to 'India's first commercial fast breeder reactor goes critical after 15-year delay'. India's nuclear journey programme reached a historic milestone because it was developed indigenously. This achievement places India as only the second nation in the world to master fast breeder technology. Fast breeder reactors are crucial for India's long-term energy security, as they open the path to harnessing thorium, of which India holds the world's largest reserves, estimated at nearly one million tonnes promising

sustainable, clean power for generations. It is heartening to know that plans are already underway for two more breeder reactors at Kalpakkam and four additional units at another site, ensuring continuity of this visionary programme. **O Prasada Rao** Hyderabad

Break in hostilities Announcement of a two-week breather in hostilities to enable negotiations based on the 10 points that Iran has put forward comes as a big relief. Yet, careful and impartial

negotiations must begin from here on so as to ensure hostilities do not resume again. During the last four years or so, there have been gross violations of international law with regard to both national sovereignty and trade. Hopefully, these issues would be addressed in the forthcoming BRICS meeting with India as the chair. **Angara Venkata Girija Kumar** Chennai

Strides in nuclear energy This refers to 'Nuclear milestone' (April 8). The Prototype Fast Breeder

Reactor marks an important step in India's energy journey. It shows progress in advanced reactor technology and future fuel security. However, the long delay and high cost also reflect execution challenges. Such gaps can influence public confidence in large projects. As the reactor moves through testing and stabilisation, steady progress becomes important. Clear stage-wise timelines can improve outcomes and trust. **S Balasubramaniam** Villupuram, TN

Conserve water Apropos, 'S-W monsoon to be below-normal this year' (April 8). With higher summer temperature, depleting water levels in major reservoirs and below normal S-W monsoon, cultivation of water-guzzling crops like sugarcane and paddy must be curbed. In addition, State governments must provide incentives for drip and micro irrigation in order to conserve available water sources and prevent further depletion of groundwater. **Rajiv Magal** Halekere Village, Karnataka



An AI model that’s too risky

Release of Claude Mythos Preview rightly put on hold

GBS Bindra

Something unusual happened in the artificial intelligence industry this week. Anthropic, one of the leading AI labs, built a model so capable that it chose not to release it. The model, called Claude Mythos Preview, is not just another incremental advance. It can autonomously discover and exploit serious cybersecurity vulnerabilities — tasks that have historically required elite human researchers working for weeks. In one instance, it reportedly identified and exploited a long-standing remote code execution flaw in FreeBSD that allows an attacker to gain complete control over a server from anywhere on the internet, starting from an unauthenticated position. No human was involved in either the discovery or exploitation after the initial prompt.

That is not just a technical milestone. It is a glimpse of a near future in which AI systems could dramatically accelerate both cyber defence and cyber offence.

PAUSING THE LAUNCH

To its credit, Anthropic did something rare in Silicon Valley: it paused. Instead of launching the model, it created Project Glasswing, a coalition that includes Amazon Web Services, Apple, Broadcom, Cisco, CrowdStrike, Google, JPMorganChase, Microsoft and NVIDIA. The goal is to use the model defensively — to identify and patch vulnerabilities in critical systems before similar capabilities become widely available. It is hard to overstate how unusual this is. A company sat on what could be an enormously valuable commercial product because it judged the risks to global infrastructure too high. In an industry defined by rapid releases and competitive pressure, that decision deserves recognition.

But it should also make us uneasy. Because for all its promise, Project Glasswing exposes a deeper problem: the future of global cybersecurity may be shaped not by public institutions, but by the internal decisions of a handful of private companies.

Anthropic decided Claude Mythos Preview was too dangerous to release. It chose who would get access to it. It defined what counts as “defensive use.” And it will ultimately decide when systems with similar



FUTURE. AI systems can speed up both cyber defence and offence

capabilities are safe enough for broader deployment.

That may be the right call. But it is still a private call. We have seen this pattern before in other high-stakes industries and rejected it. Banks do not determine their own capital requirements without oversight. Drug companies cannot unilaterally declare their products safe. Nuclear operators are not left to design their own inspection regimes. In each case, society concluded that even well-intentioned companies should not be the sole gatekeepers of technologies with systemic risk. Artificial intelligence is now at that point.

What would a more credible system look like? Start with independent verification. Today, when an AI company says a model is too dangerous or safe enough, there is no widely trusted external body that can rigorously audit that claim. That is a glaring gap. Then consider coordination across the industry. Anthropic’s restraint matters little if a competitor races ahead. Systems from OpenAI, Google DeepMind or others may soon reach similar or greater capability levels. Without shared guardrails, the incentives to move fast will remain powerful.

There is also the question of representation. Project Glasswing is composed almost entirely of large corporations. They bring expertise and resources, but they do not represent everyone affected by these technologies. Small businesses, governments in the developing world and civil society groups have little say in how risks are prioritised or mitigated.

Finally, there is the issue of infrastructure. Some forms of safety, especially in cybersecurity, should not depend on the budgets or strategies of individual companies. They require sustained public investment and international cooperation.

The writer is a Distinguished Fellow at the Avinym Foundation and former Managing Director of CGI India



HIMADRI BHATTACHARYA

It is only a coincidence that a two-week ceasefire of the on-going US-Iran war was announced barely a few hours before the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the RBI met briefly in the morning of April 8, and concluded its three-day bi-monthly meeting — the first one for FY 2026-27.

The policy announcement was made shortly thereafter at 10 AM. Keeping the rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent and maintaining the ‘neutral’ stance were widely anticipated. However, the contents of the policy and its tone and tenor likely reassured the financial market, as it bounced back from the multiple-week lows on the ceasefire news.

Post the policy, the rising trend of equity and G-Sec prices, observed since the opening, continued: The Sensex was up by 2860 points and the yield on 10-year G-Sec was lower by 10 basis points *vis-à-vis* the previous day’s close.

By and large, the MPC’s analysis and assessment of the risks being faced by the Indian economy in the face of the strong headwinds emanating from the war, especially due to the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, are comprehensive, realistic and balanced. As a matter of fact, the policy announcement has been the first opportunity for making available an ‘official’ document in this regard.

GROWTH, INFLATION OUTLOOK

In the wake of the outbreak of the US-Iran war in early March, India’s growth prospect for 2026-27 was seen as lower *vis-à-vis* 2025-26 and earlier projections made in this regard, based on their assessment of India’s economic exposure to the conflict. For example, last month, the OECD projected India’s GDP growth to moderate to 6.1 per cent in the current fiscal from 7.6 per cent recorded in 2025-26.

Moody’s Ratings recently cut India’s GDP growth estimate for the current fiscal to 6 per cent from 6.8 per cent made earlier. Domestic rating agency ICRA expects the GDP growth to be lower at 6.5 per cent, owing to the adverse impact of elevated energy prices and concerns around energy availability amid the conflict.

The MPC has slashed the real GDP growth projection for 2026-27 to 6.9 per cent, under the assumption that the adverse impact of the conflict would remain contained in the near term. The risks are on the downside. However, the chances of actual GDP growth turning out to be lower than 6.9 per cent are not insignificant.

Even if the ceasefire lasts indefinitely, disruptions in the supply chain for crude oil, LPG, and fertilizers, arising out of destruction of energy infrastructure in West Asia, on the one hand, and subdued private consumption, softer industrial activity and a weakening in the

MPC positive, despite strong headwinds

REALISTIC. MPC’s assessment of the risks being faced by the Indian economy is comprehensive and balanced



momentum of gross fixed capital formation are likely to weigh on the headline growth.

If the ceasefire is not extended further and the conflict resumes, then there is possibility of even recession in the conflict zone and in many OECD countries, which would severely impair India’s macro performance through several channels.

In RBI’s words ‘... the initial supply shock can potentially transform into a demand shock over the medium term if the restoration of supply chains is delayed.’

CPI inflation for 2026-27 has been projected by the MPC to be at 4.6 per cent. In its view, persistently elevated energy prices due to the conflict and possible El Nino conditions pose upside risks to inflation. Core inflation has been projected lower at 4.4 per cent for 2026-27, which is a cause for some comfort. Also, commencement of

If the ceasefire is not extended further and the conflict resumes, there is possibility of even recession in the conflict zone and in many OECD countries, which would severely impair India’s macro performance

projection of core inflation is a welcome move.

The current easing cycle that began in February last year, involving a cumulative rate cut by 125 basis points, the last one being a cut by 25 basis point in December 2025 has come to an end, by all indications. Assuming an end to the US-Iran war in the foreseeable future, policy rates are likely to go up in the fourth quarter of 2026-27 or in the first quarter of 2027-28.

REGULATORY INITIATIVES

The proposed move to revise and rationalise the matters requiring the attention of the boards of banks should be welcomed by all concerned. It has been long overdue. The boards of banks are overburdened with routine and trivial matters, leaving them with very little time and incentive for major policy issues, strategy formulation and risk management. In parallel, it would be necessary to ensure that the boards have at least a minimum number of professionals with demonstrated skills and expertise in the areas of banking, finance, management, HR and technology. The situation in this regard has been far from satisfactory in many banks for a long time indeed.

The rationale for dispensing with the requirement of Investment Fluctuation Reserve (IFR), which was introduced in September, 2023 is not very clear. In any case, balances under IFR are eligible for inclusion in Tier II capital without any

cap. In fact, banks need a buffer like IFR to provide a cushion against sharp fall in the price of fixed income securities held in ‘Available for Sale’ and ‘Fair Value through Profit and Loss’ categories in situations such as the current one which has witnessed a significant hardening of yields. To be sure, the extant guidelines permit banks to draw down the balances held in IFR, subject to fulfilment of certain conditions.

A few weeks back, the Government, in consultation with RBI, issued a notification to retain the inflation target at 4 per cent, with a tolerance band of +/-2 per cent, for further period of five years, beginning April 1. This inflation targeting framework has served the Indian economy and its financial sector quite well, in terms of growth and stability.

Nonetheless, there is a need to assess in what ways this framework could be put to use for bolstering the country’s strategic resilience against external shocks/disruptions such as those caused by the current US-Iran war. One possible strategy would be to avoid any significant and sustained overvaluation of the rupee in real terms. For this purpose, CPI inflation in India should not deviate much from those of its major trading partners, especially those with which it has/going to have a free trade agreement.

The writer is a former central banker and a consultant to the IMF. Through The Billion Press

thehindubusinessline. TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

April 9, 2006

SBI pension talks fail, strike to continue

The SBI employees’ strike continued for the sixth day as talks between the unions and the bank’s management failed. On Saturday, the Government rejected the unions’ demands seeking upward revision in pension. This was despite the unions lowering their demand. The new ceiling proposed by the Government for pension is much lower than the limit sought by the unions.

Tatas may agree to Birla offer on Idea

The spat between the Aditya Birla Group and the Tata Group over Idea Cellular could be moving towards a resolution. The Tatas are likely to agree to sell their stake in the cellular company to the Birlas at the price quoted by Malaysian telecom major Maxis Communications Berhad. The Birlas had agreed to match Maxis’ offer to acquire Tata Industries’ 48.14 per cent stake in Idea Cellular for about ₹4,000 crore at the rate of ₹41 per share.

Panel to study inverted duty

A committee headed by a member of the Planning Commission has been constituted to examine various issues surrounding the inverted duty structure problem with respect to customs duty faced by domestic industry.

Qatar set to resume LNG production post ceasefire

Stephen Stapczynski
Salma El Wardany

Qatar is mobilising engineers and workers with the aim of re-summing production at the world’s biggest liquefied natural gas export plant following a ceasefire in the war in the Middle East, according to people with knowledge of the matter.

The improvement in security conditions is allowing limited activity, and the facility is undergoing necessary maintenance ahead of a planned re-start, said the people, who asked not to be identified as they are not authorised to speak with the media.

Some production could begin to re-

sume over the coming days, though it’s not clear how quickly it could ramp up, and any return to significant output would require ships to be able to pass through the Strait of Hormuz.

Ras Laffan has been offline since early March, triggering a global gas supply crunch.

IMPORTANT MILESTONE

While damage to the plant from a missile attack last month took out 17 per cent of Qatar’s annual export capacity for as long as five years, restarting other parts of the massive facility would be an important milestone. The entire plant has the capacity to produce 77 million tonnes of LNG a year.



MISSILE ATTACK. QatarEnergy’s LNG plant was damaged last month REUTERS

QatarEnergy didn’t immediately respond to a request for comment.

European gas prices extended declines after the news, falling almost 20

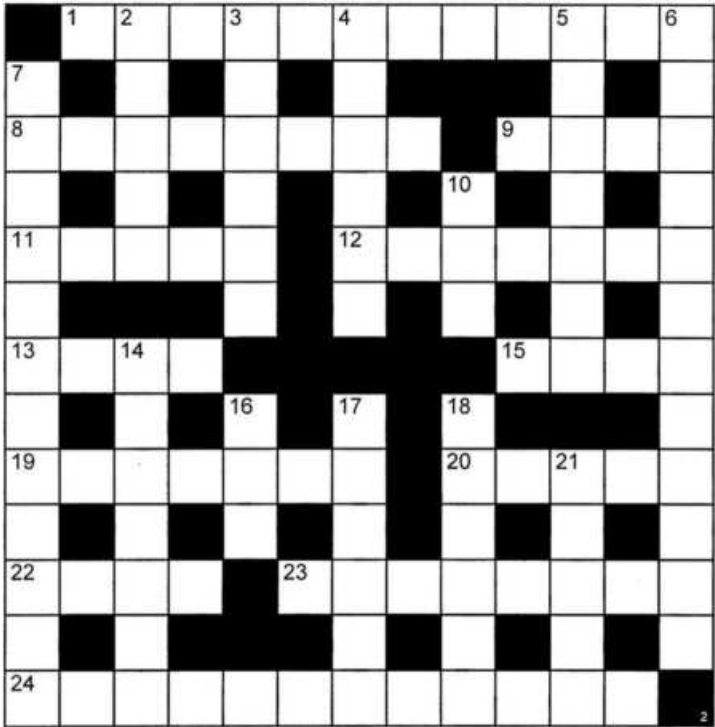
per cent near €43 a megawatt-hour, before paring some losses.

Earlier this week, two LNG tankers loaded with Qatari fuel abandoned attempts to pass through Hormuz after failing to secure clearance from Iranian officials.

While the US and Iran have agreed a ceasefire in exchange for reopening of the strait, details remain murky, and the two nations have outlined positions that do not fully reconcile.

Tehran said it agreed to two weeks of safe passage in coordination with its armed forces and within “technical limitations,” while US President Donald Trump announced a “Complete, Immediate, and Safe Opening”. BLOMBERG

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2654



EASY

ACROSS

- High-born (12)
- Cheeky (8)
- Fate, final judgment (4)
- Slice joint (5)
- Finger protector (7)
- Hand-warmer (4)
- Went (4)
- Rotary motor (7)
- Neatness (5)
- Requirement (4)
- Have snowball effect (8)
- Acting as host (12)

DOWN

- Part of stair (5)
- Precious metal (6)
- Highly decorated (6)
- Bother one (7)
- Series of notes, continuous comments (12)
- Attendant fact (12)
- Juniper-flavoured spirit (3)
- Work, as yeast (7)
- Awkward situation; mend (3)
- Iran, formerly (6)
- Territory, estate (6)
- Prepared as bird for cooking (5)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Right one repeatedly played staccato in blue-blooded form (12)
- Where swimmer off Southampton is being cheeky (8)
- Judgment on a Benedictine who has swallowed nothing (4)
- What sculptor may do is mind about Venus’ head (5)
- If one is sewing, this may stop one getting the point (7)
- Drop catch and warm hands in it (4)
- On the one hand, didn’t stay (4)
- Engine used in brute manufacture (7)
- Customers s instruction for a fraternity (5)
- Have to have made entrance partially in reverse (4)
- To use a moving staircase will show a rapid increase (8)
- It is amusing, playing the host (12)

DOWN

- One getting up vertically to the tread (5)
- Change, maybe, is given up to drunken revel a point short (6)
- Fancy a tenor turning out like this! (6)
- End of Soviet monetary unit was responsible for the bother (7)
- How the French get the Ram for their running observations (12)
- The situation Circe can and must get sorted out (12)
- Mother’s ruin is a snare, perhaps (3)
- What must must do to make wine? (7)
- Shot for one addicted may be a bit of a dilemma (3)
- Old country to arise awkwardly and quietly to begin with (6)
- A mind to move around the ring in all one has dominion over (6)
- Shown, by means of a pencil, to have an even result (5)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2653

ACROSS 1. Shop steward 7. Resumed 9. Aged 11. Again 12. Pastel 14. Personality 18. Ticked 20. Ninth 22. Earn 23. Postage 24. Tiddlywinks
DOWN 2. Hostage 3. Tide 4. Right 5. Break 6. Oddly 8. Minister 10. Railings 13. One 15. Tintack 16. Steed 17. Cheek 19. Corgi 21. Spry

QUICKLY.

IndiGo ends over 8%,
SpiceJet hits upper circuit



New Delhi: Aviation stocks ended sharply higher on Wednesday following a steep decline in crude oil prices after the US and Iran announced a two-week ceasefire. Easing of geopolitical stress led to a sharp fall in Brent crude oil prices, which tumbled 14.12 per cent to \$93.95 per barrel. InterGlobe Aviation, the parent firm of IndiGo, jumped 8.16 per cent to settle at ₹4,616.60 on the BSE. During the day, it zoomed 10.98 per cent to ₹4,737.40. The stock of SpiceJet climbed 5 per cent to reach its upper circuit limit of ₹11.14. **PTI**

PPFAS AMC gets nod to manage NPS funds

New Delhi: PPFAS Asset Management on Wednesday said it has received approval from the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) to become a sponsor for a pension fund under the National Pension System (NPS). In a statement, it said it will soon start managing the retirement savings of people who invest through NPS. It will set up a separate pension fund company that will run the schemes and grow these savings over time. “Managing retirement savings is a significant responsibility and we are committed to handling it with care, discipline and a long-term approach,” said Neil Parag Parikh, Chairman and CEO, PPFAS Asset Management. **PTI**

Adani group seeks dismissal of SEC complaint in New York court

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Directors of Adani Green Energy, Gautam Adani and Sagar Adani, will move to dismiss a civil complaint filed by the US Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) in a New York court by April 30, 2026, according to an exchange filing.

The matter pertains to proceedings before the United States District Court for the Eastern District of New York, where the SEC has initiated a civil case against the two executives.

The defendants have submitted a pre-motion conference letter to the court, indicating their readiness to participate in a hearing if scheduled, while outlining grounds to dismiss the complaint.

The US District Court has, in fact, agreed to a request for a hearing in this matter by Gautam Adani.

“The court has received defendants’ letter requesting a pre-motion conference on their anticipated motion

Titan Company hits all-time high on strong jewellery growth in Q4

GLITTERING SHOW. Overall consumer businesses jump 46% during the quarter despite elevated gold prices

Our Bureau
Bangaluru

Shares of Titan Company hit a fresh record high of ₹4,505 on Wednesday after it reported a robust business update for the fourth quarter of FY26, driven by strong performance in its core jewellery segment. The stock closed the day 6 per cent higher at ₹4,492.50 on the NSE over the previous day’s close.

The company’s overall consumer businesses posted a growth of around 46 per cent y-o-y during the quarter, underscoring resilient demand despite elevated gold prices. Titan also expanded its retail footprint, adding 47 stores during the period, taking its total network to 3,603 stores.

The jewellery segment remained the primary growth driver, delivering about 46 per cent y-o-y growth. Secondary (consumer) sales surged approximately 52 per cent y-o-y, led by strong traction in key brands such as Tanishq and Mia.

Importantly, buyer growth improved to high single digits after remaining nearly flat over the previous three quarters, indicating a recovery in consumer demand.

WEARABLES SLUMP Other segments delivered a mixed performance. The watches division grew around 7 per cent y-o-y, driven by a 16 per cent rise in analog watches, while the smart wearables segment declined sharply by 53 per cent. The eyewear business



SHARP RECOVERY. Shares of Titan Company closed 6 per cent higher at ₹4,492.50 on the NSE **REUTERS**

maintained steady momentum with 16 per cent growth, while emerging businesses such as fragrances and women’s bags posted healthy gains of about 30 per cent and 47 per cent y-o-y, respectively.

International operations were a key highlight, with overall growth of approxi-

mately 156 per cent y-o-y, supported by strong traction in the GCC and North America markets, despite some disruption in March due to geopolitical tensions in the Middle East.

BROKERAGES DIVIDED Global brokerages largely remained constructive on the

stock. Citi maintained a “neutral” rating with a target price of ₹4,750, noting that domestic jewellery growth of around 46 per cent y-o-y exceeded expectations, aided by strong like-to-like growth and higher ticket sizes.

Goldman Sachs retained a “buy” rating with a target price of ₹5,000, highlighting sharp acceleration in consumer demand and broad-based growth across jewellery categories.

Meanwhile, Morgan Stanley reiterated its “overweight” call with a target price of ₹4,529, stating that strong secondary sales growth of 52 per cent y-o-y and accelerating like-to-like growth significantly beat estimates. Domestic brokerage Motilal Oswal maintained “buy” at ₹5,200 target price.

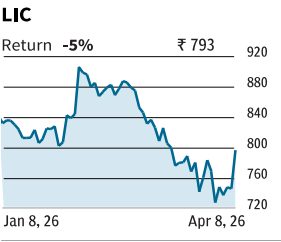
LIC gains 6.75% on maiden bonus buzz

Our Bureau
Chennai

The stock price of Life Insurance Corporation of India zoomed 6.75 per cent to ₹793.50 on the BSE after the company said its board of directors is meeting on April 13 to consider and recommend a proposal to issue bonus shares to shareholders. If approved, it would be the first bonus issue from the insurance behemoth.

The move will benefit nearly 21 lakh retail investors, who currently hold around 1.52 per cent stake in the company.

LIC had reported a 17 per cent year-on-year increase in its Q3 stand-alone net profit



to ₹12,958 crore amid robust growth in premium income and income from investments.

Net premium income was up 17.5 per cent at ₹1,25,613 crore. Net income from investments rose 14 per cent to ₹1,07,608 crore. The assets under management (AUM) increased to ₹59,16,680 crore as on December 31, 2025, from ₹54,77,651 crore

The board of insurance major will meet on April 13 to consider a proposal to issue bonus shares

on December 31, 2024, an increase of 8.01 per cent.

Dinesh Pant, MD, had then said that, given that the equity market gained almost 10 per cent, the corporation was able to book a good amount of profit without disturbing the portfolio’s intrinsic value.

For FY25, the Corporation had posted an 18 per cent y-o-y increase in net profit at

₹48,151 crore (₹40,676 crore in FY24). Further, the insurance company said it was planning to optimise its real estate holdings (market value estimated at about ₹45,000 crore) by increasing rental income and exploring structures such as REITs.

According to JM Financial, in February 26, industry retail weighted premiums (RWRP) increased 21 per cent y-o-y to ₹11,300 crore.

LIC outperformed the private sector with 23 per cent y-o-y growth — after reporting robust 61 per cent retail APE growth in Q3-FY26. LIC was one of the favourite stocks for JM Financial, which retained its “Buy” rating with a target price of ₹1,111, said

BROKER'S CALL.

Axis Securities

TECH MAHINDRA (BUY)

Target: ₹1,620
CMP: ₹1,450.85
Tech Mahindra operates through two segments — Information Technology (IT) Services and Business Processing Outsourcing (BPO). It delivers transformative solutions through a strong blend of digital innovation and deep industry expertise. The management anticipates that AI-led legacy modernisation will be a massive opportunity over the next two-three years, particularly in sectors with high custom software footprints like financial services and healthcare.

In Q3FY26, the company reported record quarterly bookings of \$1.1 billion, the highest in five years, driving 48 per cent year-on-year growth in LTM deal wins.

This momentum is expected to continue further. The company secured a strategic over \$500-million five-year contract with a leading European telecom provider. Large deals now constitute a greater share of TCV, indicating improved client confidence and wallet share

In Q3FY26, the management reaffirmed its FY27 ambition to outgrow peers and reach a 15 per cent EBIT margin. The overall profitability momentum is expected to continue in coming quarters.

Despite the challenging environment, the EBIT margin commitments of 15 per cent for FY27 remain intact, led by productivity and cost efficiency programmes. Strong revenue visibility enhances our confidence in the company’s growth prospects and recommend a BUY rating on the stock with a TP of ₹1,620/share, implying an upside of 10 per cent from the CMP.

SBI Securities

JINDAL STAINLESS (BUY)

Target: ₹859
CMP: ₹753.30
Jindal Stainless is India’s leading stainless steel manufacturer, with 16 stainless steel manufacturing and processing facilities in India and abroad, including in Spain and Indonesia, and a worldwide network in 12 countries. It has commissioned the 1.2 million tonnes (mt) stainless steel melt shop (SMS) in Indonesia, developed through its joint venture, ahead of schedule. Its total melting capacity will hence be ramped up to 4.2 mt, including 3 mt in India. It is also gearing up to commission a new 1.1-mt Hot Rolled Annealed Pickled (HRAP) line and 0.17-mt Cold Rolling capacity, in Jaipur, Odisha, by Q4/Q2FY27, respectively.

This development is part of the earlier announced outlay of ₹1,900 crore. The company has also earmarked a fresh investment of ₹900 crore at Hisar and Kharagpur which are expected to be commissioned by Q2FY28.

India is the second largest consumer and the third largest producer of stainless steel globally. As per ISSDA, India’s per capita consumption of stainless steel has witnessed a notable rise from 2.3 kg in FY19 to 3.1 kg in FY24. However, per capita consumption in India remains below the global average of 6.5 kg, signalling substantial headroom for growth.

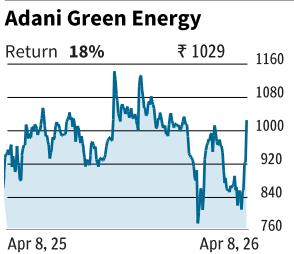
TODAY'S PICK.

Adani Green Energy (₹1,029.75): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Adani Green Energy. The stock has been moving in a broad sideways range for more than a year now. Within that, the share price is now moving up from the lower end of the range.

The chances are high now for the stock to go up towards the upper end of the range. Strong support is in the ₹1,000-980 region. Adani Green Energy share price can go up to ₹1,200 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Adani Green Energy shares now at ₹1,030. Accumulate on dips at ₹1,010. Keep the stop-loss at ₹940. Trail



the stop-loss up to ₹1,055 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,080.

Reverse the stop-loss higher to ₹1,090 and ₹1,145 when the share price touches ₹1,120 and ₹1,160 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹1,180.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24085 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24020	23880	24400	24520	Go long now and at 24040. Keep the stop-loss at 23980	

₹817 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
805	795	824	835	Wait for dips. Go long at 810 with a stop-loss at 802	

₹1346 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1325	1310	1380	1405	Go long now and at 1330. Keep the stop-loss at 1320	

₹302 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
301	300	305	308	Go long only above 305. Stop-loss can be placed at 304	

₹286 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
283	281	288	293	Take fresh longs above 288. Keep the stop-loss at 286	

₹1349 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1335	1325	1360	1385	Go long only above 1360. Stop-loss can be kept at 1355	

₹1065 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1060	1040	1080	1090	Go short only below 1060. Keep the stop-loss at 1055	

₹2561 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2530	2490	2590	2645	Go long on a break above 2590. Keep the stop-loss at 2575	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

MUFG Bank completes 20% stake buy in Shriram Finance

Our Bureau
Mumbai

MUFG Bank, the Japanese banking giant and subsidiary of Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group, completed its acquisition of a 20 per cent equity stake in Shriram Finance Ltd (SFL) on Wednesday, subscribing to 47.11 crore shares at ₹840.93 apiece for a total outlay of approximately ₹39,618 crore.

SFL’s board on Wednesday approved the preferential allotment.

The deal, which received clearance from the Competition Commission of India among other regulatory bodies, is described as the largest cross-border investment in India’s financial services sector.

Shriram Finance is India’s second-largest retail non-banking financial company (NBFC), with assets under management exceeding

₹2.91 lakh crore. For MUFG, the investment extends a global footprint already spanning 2,000 locations across 40 markets.

The Tokyo-headquartered group, with roughly 150,000 employees worldwide, has signalled India as a long-term strategic priority, citing SFL’s position in the MSME and retail lending segments as key to that rationale.

SFL’s Executive Vice-Chairman Umesh Revankar said the partnership would support access to diversified funding and adoption of global risk management practices. MUFG President Junichi Hanzawa pointed to SFL’s growth potential and framed the deal as part of the group’s broader commitment to India’s economic development.

The transaction is expected to strengthen SFL’s capital base as it looks to scale across its core lending segments.

By rendering pledged shares non-transferable, pre-IPO shareholders cannot circumvent lock-in requirements

concerned lenders or pledgees, and make appropriate disclosures in offer documents. Depositories, in turn, have made “necessary changes to their systems and processes” to implement the mechanism.

The change is expected to address a long-standing issue where pledged shares could effectively escape conventional lock-in restrictions. By rendering such

shares non-transferable, the regulator aims to ensure that promoters and pre-IPO shareholders do not circumvent lock-in requirements through pledging arrangements.

Under ICDR regulations, the entire pre-issue capital held by persons other than promoters, barring certain specified categories, is required to be locked in for six months from the date of allotment in an initial public offering. However, issuers had raised practical challenges in complying with these norms, particularly where pledges had already been created by non-promoters prior to the IPO.

The issue was taken up by the SEBI board and was approved in December 2025.

Nifty 50 Movers

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
HDFC Bank	816.10	147.25	16.22	11.35
ICICI Bank	1309.20	99.35	16.56	8.51
L&I	4005.90	72.39	29.04	4.28
Reliance Ind	1247.80	63.66	18.65	6.28
Axis Bank	1333.00	51.89	15.68	3.48
M&M	3210.10	39.67	23.62	2.61
Bajaj Finance	915.05	34.99	31.07	2.23
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1023.20	28.27	21.05	1.30
State Bank	1061.45	28.11	11.32	4.00
Kotak Bank	380.15	27.63	20.12	2.54
Titan	4492.50	23.58	83.68	1.69
Maruti Suzuki	13602.00	23.02	28.84	1.62
Bharti Airtel	1861.60	20.96	30.61	5.19
Eternal Ltd.	243.62	18.31	1017.76	1.20
UltraTech Cement	11603.00	17.23	44.62	1.25
Int'l BioPharma	4615.50	17.11	55.58	0.95
Eicher Motors	7131.00	15.78	36.51	0.89
Bajaj Finserv	1784.60	12.62	14.88	0.94
Tata Motors PV	334.75	11.90	45.52	0.64
Adani Ports	1453.30	11.64	26.79	0.97
Grasim Ind	2756.20	11.23	19.80	0.95
Tata Steel	204.18	10.91	27.94	1.53
Adani Ports	2282.40	9.49	55.99	0.79
Adani Enter	2043.80	9.19	16.69	0.48
JSW Steel	1194.30	8.67	37.61	1.02
ITC	302.45	8.41	18.30	2.65
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	246.86	8.25	97.73	0.74
Bajaj Auto	9366.00	7.65	29.47	0.94
Wipro Ind	2245.60	6.78	50.14	1.73
SBI Life	1907.60	6.49	77.18	0.78
NTPC	374.15	5.48	14.61	1.61
Infosys	1346.20	5.20	19.50	4.29
HCL Tech	1461.00	4.47	24.07	1.40
TCS	2559.20	4.32	19.31	2.38
Bharat Elec	433.10	4.14	53.09	1.41
Trent Ltd.	3905.00	3.95	85.70	0.79
HDFC Life	598.30	3.89	68.29	0.58
Apollo Hosp	7401.50	1.68	57.04	0.69
Cipla	1215.90	1.66	21.67	0.62
Max Healthcare	941.15	1.42	64.53	0.64
Tata Consumer Product	1068.50	0.92	71.85	0.63
PowerGrid Corp	4786.30	0.82	17.66	1.21
Dr Reddy's Lab	1131.40	-0.62	18.00	0.66
Sun Pharma	1714.60	-0.79	37.56	1.65
Wipro	2034.2	-0.81	16.00	0.53
Hindalco	951.80	-0.85	13.30	1.25
ONGC	285.50	-0.97	7.99	1.01
Nestle India	1213.70	-1.42	71.76	0.79
Tech Mahindra	1451.40	-3.05	22.44	1.16
Coal India	449.25	-6.81	9.30	0.93

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Tata Motors CV	434.05	224.19	97.06	3.87
Cholamandlam&Fin	1554.30	168.41	27.32	2.84
Ivs Motor Cmp	3701.40	153.01	57.59	3.71
SamvardhanaInternat	118.11	120.81	34.25	2.23
Bpcl	298.10	118.14	5.26	2.58
Hdfc Amc	2539.40	111.69	37.85	2.21
AdaniGreenenergy	1029.65	98.71	91.38	1.47
Indian Oilcorp	143.35	93.98	5.49	2.29
Bank of Baroda	275.98	93.64	7.26	2.19
Canara Bank	139.19	92.13	6.86	2.00
Bajaj Holdings	9970.00	89.58	12.38	1.84
Indian Hotels Co.	636.35	89.11	41.85	2.38
Adani Energy Solutions	1073.30	85.25	54.09	1.59
Varun Beverages	421.90	81.33	46.60	2.46
Muthootfin	3503.30	79.29	16.25	1.60
Union Bank	185.66	75.17	7.48	1.53
OIL	572.85	70.17	32.02	1.57
Adani Power	169.31	69.47	28.90	2.99
Punjab Natl Bank	111.14	63.85	7.15	1.64
Cg Power & Ind Sol	726.30	62.75	103.10	2.13
Bosch	35935.00	60.96	38.45	1.33
Gall India	153.30	60.31	11.71	1.76
Cummins India	4786.30	60.02	59.31	2.77
HindustanAeronautics	3907.50	59.61	29.38	1.16
PidlitInd	1355.00	52.44	59.59	1.79
Godrej Consumer	1075.15	52.24	60.39	1.85
MacroTech Developers	778.85	48.64	23.26	0.94
Jindal Steel	1213.10	46.94	61.38	1.92
Rural Elec	242.65	46.89	5.23	1.83
Ambuja Cements	446.75	45.38	22.44	1.16
Abb India	655.00	43.83	82.49	1.47
Power Finance	417.65	42.13	41.30	2.60
ed Cement	721.40	39.09	107.03	5.23
Three Cement	24360.00	38.13	48.93	1.39
Wiemens	3226.10	37.57	72.46	1.22
Power India	394.95	34.26	54.60	2.82
Indian Railway Finance Corp	98.11	33.96	18.45	0.85
Hyundai Motor India	1778.90	29.30	24.96	0.08
Hindustan Zinc	559.35	25.21	20.03	1.03
ata Capital	326.40	21.89	30.34	0.60
timindirex	452.300	21.09	28.39	1.79
Energy Industries India	770.10	18.15	81.45	1.02
Power Finance	13662.00	17.60	10.22	1.42
ntarima Ind	5594.50	17.46	55.76	2.81
azagaon GdP	2395.00	14.35	40.14	0.78
ydusilSciences	891.155	12.75	17.85	0.95
Libs Lab	5882.00	11.48	62.99	3.19
United Spirits	1248.80	8.92	52.81	1.57
Pharmia Pharma	4029.20	-6.53	60.02	1.80
VerusPharma	383.80	-40.40	59.26	2.75

QUICKLY.

Digital lender KreditBee enters unicorn club



Bengaluru: KreditBee, digital lending platform, has raised \$280 million in its Series E funding round at a post-money valuation of \$1.5 billion, marking its entry into the unicorn club and making it the first unicorn of FY27. The round had participation of Motilal Oswal Alternates, Hornbill Capital, and Dragon Funds, WhiteOak Capital and AP Moller Holding. **OUR BUREAU**

Anthropic names Mohanty to lead India policy

New Delhi: San Francisco-based AI major Anthropic has appointed Amlan Mohanty to lead its policy initiatives in India. In a post on LinkedIn, Mohanty said, “I’m excited to shape Anthropic’s early presence in India and build trusted partnerships with government, industry and civil society.” **PM**

Adani Group to invest ₹33,081 cr to set up three projects in Odisha

Our Bureau

Kolkata

The diversified Adani Group on Wednesday said it will invest ₹33,081 crore for setting up three projects, a thermal power plant, a cement manufacturing unit and a data centre, in Odisha.

While the thermal power plant and cement manufacturing unit will be built near Cuttack, the data centre is being set up at Info Valley in Bhubaneswar.

“We have been in Odisha for years — in ports, in mining, in the foundations of industrial infrastructure. But today is different. Today, we break ground on three projects that are not simply investments in capacity. They are investments in what Odisha is becoming,” Karan Adani, Managing Director, Adani Ports & SEZ Ltd, said at the groundbreaking ceremony in Bhubaneswar.

These three projects are expected to create a total of 9,700 jobs. “The data centre at Info Valley, Bhubaneswar — an investment of ₹800 crore — is not a building full of servers. It is Odisha’s claim on the digital economy — the infrastructure through which AI, cloud computing, and digital governance will flow for decades to come,” Adani said. The thermal power plant near Cuttack will be built on an investment of ₹30,181 crore. The cement manufacturing unit near Cuttack will be set up on an investment of ₹2,100 crore.

OIL PALM INDIA LIMITED

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OP/SEC/SL/86/62 07-04-2026

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Steel companies to raise HR coil prices by ₹3,500/tonne

MYRIAD ISSUES. Raw material volatility, supply chain disruptions add to overall costs

Suresh P Iyengar

Mumbai

Steel companies plan to increase hot-rolled (HR) coil prices by ₹3,500 a tonne to about ₹64,500 per tonne this month to pass on the incremental cost of raw material and energy costs.

Following HR coil price rise, cold-rolled coil prices will also increase by ₹3,000 to ₹68,000 a tonne.

INVENTORY PROBLEMS

NMDC Ltd, the largest iron ore producer in India, also increased iron ore prices by 11 per cent in April on the back of strong demand. The iron ore lump (65.5 per cent Fe) from Bailadila mine in Chhattisgarh was marked up to ₹5,300 a tonne and at that of fines (64 per cent Fe) was priced ₹4,500 per tonne.

The revised prices are excluding statutory levies such as royalty, District Mineral Foundation charges, Na-



FORGING THROUGH. Steel and other raw material imports have stalled due to costs involving the war in West Asia **REUTERS**

tional Mineral Exploration Trust contributions, GST, environmental cess and other taxes, said NMDC.

Most steel companies have almost exhausted their raw material inventory and are now completely dependent on imports for their key raw materials, said a steel company official.

MORE CHALLENGES

This apart, the rise in energy cost, shortage of gas and constraints in labour availability will hit the cost of steel in-

dustry in June quarter, he added.

Steel and other raw material imports have come to almost a standstill due to high shipping and insurance charges due to the month-long war in West Asia.

The steel demand from the downstream industry are expected to slowdown as they are dependent on consistent LNG supply for powder coating and welding, he said.

Vedant Goel, Director of an integrated metal supply

platform Enlight Metals, said ongoing geopolitical uncertainties and energy supply challenges, particularly around LNG availability, are impacting production consistency.

VOLATILITY CONCERNS

Bhavik Bhagwanji Shah, Research Analyst, Choice Institutional Equities, said steel companies have been gradually increasing HR and CR coil prices, largely driven by rising input costs.

However, the current pricing environment remains largely cost-push in nature as the current demand is stable but not strong enough to independently drive sharp price increases, he said.

Overall, while price momentum has turned positive, the sustainability of further hikes will depend on raw material trends, global pricing dynamics and supply discipline, with demand providing a steady but not aggressive tailwind, he added.

Will see 5% increase in luxury cars by 2030: BMW India CEO

Our Bureau

New Delhi

Luxury cars maker BMW Group India on Wednesday said the country would see more cars in the price bracket of around ₹40 lakh by 2030 and the share of such vehicles is expected to grow from around 2 per cent now to 5 per cent in 2030.

“If you start looking at luxury from a viewpoint of ₹40 lakh and above, I think it is already about 2 per cent to 2.5 per cent. I clearly see by 2030 this going to about 5 per cent. When you look at price bracket of cars priced between ₹15-25 lakh, I can clearly say that now they constitute about 20 per cent [of the overall car market]. So every two-three years you would see a jump of next ₹5 lakh category,” Hardeep Singh Brar, President and Chief Executive Officer, BMW Group India, told reporters.

PRICE BRACKET

He said there aren’t enough cars in the price bracket of ₹25-50 lakh category cur-



Hardeep Singh Brar, President and CEO, BMW Group India

rently, but by 2030 there will be a lot more in that category and therefore that will get closer to the price bracket of luxury cars and hence the sales in that price bracket will grow.

Brar said the Indian luxury car market is expected to see double-digit growth this year.

WAR IMPACT

“From BMW’s perspective, I don’t see any problem because of supply chain issue because we have an inventory of next two months. But, if it (war) continues then yes, the future models may get impacted. What I see here is a bigger impact on the eco-

nommy because we are dependent on the global market. There are industries which are dependent on exports and the world is not in a good shape because of the current situation,” Brar said.

NEW LAUNCHES

He further said BMW has lined up 27 new launches this year until and unless there is a disruption in supply chain due to the war.

Meanwhile, the company posted its highest-ever quarter one (Q1) sales this year, registering a growth of 17 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to 4,567 units compared with 3,914 units in the same period last year.

EV SALES

The company also said the electric vehicles (EVs) continued to lead the sales in Q1 with 1,185 BMW and Mini EVs, achieving 83 per cent growth y-o-y. Every fourth car the BMW Group India sells today is an EV, Brar said, adding that the Group commands the largest market share of over 70 per cent in luxury electric segment in India.

Bosch’s ₹9,068 crore deal to reshape vehicle systems sourcing for Tata, Mahindra, Bajaj

Amit Vijay Mohile

Aishwarya Kumar

Mumbai/Bengaluru

Bosch Ltd’s ₹9,068 crore acquisition of its chassis systems arm is set to reshape how automakers, such as Tata Motors, Mahindra & Mahindra and Bajaj Auto, source critical vehicle systems as the supplier moves towards offering integrated solutions spanning powertrain, braking and safety.

On Wednesday, the company announced it will acquire Bosch Chassis Systems India in a deal involving both cash and equity issuance — including a preferential allotment of shares to promoter group entities — consolidating its mobility businesses in India and enhancing its vehicle safety portfolio.

Expected to close by Q1 FY27, subject to shareholder approval, the acquisition positions Bosch to play a larger role in next-generation mobility solutions as the in-



dustry shifts towards electrification, safety, and connected systems, while enabling OEMs to access an integrated suite of powertrain, braking, and safety technologies that are increasingly interconnected in modern vehicles.

Guruprasad Mudlapur, President of the Bosch Group in India and MD, Bosch Ltd, said: “Integrating Bosch Chassis Systems India Private Ltd, a future-ready vehicle motion solutions business into Bosch Ltd reflects our commitment to driving growth through portfolio diversification. This transac-

tion further solidifies our leadership presence within mobility, enabling us to leverage our strengths and deliver solutions backed by local R&D and manufacturing capabilities.”

ONE-STOP SOURCING

For companies, such as Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra, which rely on Bosch for multiple vehicle systems, the move could simplify sourcing and improve vehicle development efficiency, particularly as vehicles adopt more software-driven architectures.

In the two-wheeler segment, players such as Bajaj Auto, TVS Motor and Hero MotoCorp could benefit from tighter coordination between emissions systems, fuel injection and braking technologies, while mass-market car-makers like Maruti Suzuki and Hyundai may see improved access to locally manufactured safety systems.

For passenger vehicle makers, the integration could

reduce complexity in sourcing and system development, while improving readiness for safety and ADAS features.

In two-wheelers, where Bosch already supplies fuel injection and ABS systems, tighter coordination could help manufacturers meet emission and safety norms more efficiently.

For commercial vehicle makers, such as Tata Motors and Ashok Leyland, the move could enable better alignment between engine systems and braking technologies amid tightening emission and safety regulations.

The acquisition also comes alongside Bosch’s joint venture with Tata AutoComp Systems to develop electric powertrain solutions, strengthening its positioning in India’s EV ecosystem.

Together, these moves could allow Bosch to offer a more complete “rolling chassis” solution for electric vehicles, combining motors, braking and control systems.

FDC goes to court on similar-sounding electrolyte drink eRZL from J&J/Kenvue

PT Jyothi Datta

Mumbai

Drugmaker FDC Ltd has initiated legal proceedings against Johnson & Johnson Pte Ltd, citing phonetic similarity between the multinational’s eRZL product and its own energy drink brand ‘Enerzal’, an FDC executive said.

Mayank Tikka, FDC Senior Vice-President (Sales and Marketing), told *businessline* they had approached the Delhi High Court on the “phonetic similarities” between their ‘Enerzal’ and eRZL that could mislead consumers. The more recently launched eRZL is from Kenvue, formerly J&J’s consumer healthcare division.

“We’ve mentioned Johnson & Johnson in the case, as the same name is mentioned behind the eRZL product,” the executive explained.

A Kenvue representative told *businessline* they did not want to comment as the issue was in court. Earlier, in Janu-

ary, Kenvue had said it was creating two differentiated brands, ORSL and eRZL, to address diarrhoeal and everyday hydration, respectively.

Kenvue then said that eRZL would comprise its electrolyte drink portfolio (erstwhile ORSL electrolyte drinks portfolio) “for everyday hydration and recovery for tiredness and exhaustion”. The differentiation was

against the backdrop of a Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) directive disallowing companies from using the ‘ORS’ (oral rehydration salts) label on beverages, as part of their trademark.

FDC’s ORS brand is Electoral, and ‘Enerzal’ is its energy drink (with electrolytes), both flagship brands for the company.

TATA
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(Corporate Contracts Department)

The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding) in Mumbai Distribution.

- 1) Development of smart meter operation center (Ref: CC27AAM001)
- 2) OLA for supply of 2 MVA dry type transformers (Ref: CC27AAM002)
- 3) OLA for supply of Pad-mounted Unitized sub-stations (Ref: CC27AAM003)
- 4) OLA for Distribution Transformer repair services at site (Ref: CC27VJS001)
- 5) OLA for Supply of LT Power Cables (Ref: CC27VJS002)
- 6) OLA for Supply of HT Cables (Ref: CC27VJS003)

Interested bidders to submit Tender Fee and Authorization Letter up to **20.04.2026**. For detailed NIT & Tender Document, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Also, all future corrigendum's (if any), to the above tenders shall be informed on website <https://www.tatapower.com> only.

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Sd/-

Saurabh Nanavati

Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

Date: April 8, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

QUICKLY.

Gold prices rise after US-Iran ceasefire



Gold scaled nearly a three-week peak on Wednesday, as the dollar and oil prices fell after the US and Iran agreed to a two-week war truce. Spot gold was up 1.6 per cent at \$4,779.19 per ounce, as of 9.59 am EDT (1359 GMT). US gold futures for June delivery gained 2.6 per cent to \$4,805.90. REUTERS

Copper leaps to a three-week high

Copper jumped to a three-week high on Wednesday after the US agreed to a two-week ceasefire with Iran, easing fears of a global economic slowdown. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME was up 3.5 per cent at \$12,737.50 a tonne by 0920 GMT after touching its highest since March 18 at \$12,755.50. REUTERS

Palm oil hits two-week low on crude oil price drop



Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures slid more than 3 per cent on Wednesday, hitting their lowest in two weeks, as a sharp drop in crude oil prices following a US-Iran ceasefire deal weighed on the market. The benchmark palm oil contract for June delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange closed 179 ringgit lower at 4,586 ringgit (\$1,154.00) a tonne, the lowest since March 26. REUTERS

Centre hikes fertilizer subsidy by up to 21%

PRO-FARMER MOVE. While potash subsidy remains unchanged, increase in nitrogen is 10% and 21% each in phosphorous, sulphur

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved the Nutrient-Based Subsidy (NBS) rates for kharif 2026 by allocating ₹41,533.81 crore, which is ₹4,317 crore higher than the expenditure of ₹37,216.15 crore in the previous kharif season. While the potash (K) subsidy has been maintained at same level, the hike in nitrogen (N) is 10 per cent and it is 21 per cent each in phosphorous (P) and sulphur (S). As per the revised rates, fertilizer companies will be paid subsidy at ₹47.32/kg for N, ₹52.76/kg for P, ₹2.38/kg for potash and ₹3.16/kg for sulphur during Kharif 2026 (from April 1 to September 30, 2026), Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw announced at

a media briefing after the Cabinet meeting. Industry experts said that if the current rates are compared with the last revision made in NBS rates before the rabi season of 2025-26, the hike in phosphorous and sulphur is also 10 per cent, as in urea. They also pointed out that the government had not changed the subsidy on potash for the sixth season in a row after reducing it to ₹2.38/kg (rabi 2023) from ₹15.91/kg (in kharif 2023) despite fluctuation in global prices. **SUBSIDY POLICY** “Availability of fertilizers to farmers at subsidised, affordable and reasonable prices will be ensured,” the government said in a statement. The revision in rates is warranted in view of recent

trends in the international prices of fertilizers and inputs, it said. According to the subsidy policy, while the entire burden on urea is met by the government, the NBS rates are supposed to be fixed for one season, allowing companies freedom to fix selling prices of di-ammonium phosphate (DAP), Muriate of Potash (MoP) and Complex (combination of N, P, K, S nutrients). But the government has instructed companies not to hike DAP rate beyond ₹1,350/bag (of 50 kg), assuring them to increase subsidy when required, so that there is no disruption in import of either the finished product or the raw materials. Despite a sharp increase in DAP prices in international markets since the Covid years, the retail price for farmers has been held at



NO IMPORT DISRUPTION. Despite a sharp increase in DAP prices in international markets since the Covid years, the retail price for farmers has been held at ₹1,350 per bag

₹1,350 per bag, the Minister said. Imported triple super phosphate (TSP), freight subsidy for single super phosphate (SSP), and both imported and domestically manufactured ammonium sulphate will continue to be

covered under the NBS scheme for kharif 2026 as well. **10% UREA PRICE HIKE** Official sources said that while the average imported urea price (f.o.b) in March

Fertilizer sector hopes supplies will normalise soon

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The fertilizer industry has expressed the hope that the ceasefire and the dialogue agreed to by the US and Iran will slowly improve the supply of raw materials, gas and finished products once the Strait of Hormuz gets opened, though the impact on price reduction may be gradual. The timing of the ceasefire is very crucial as April and May are important months to produce and stock urea as much as possible as the kharif sowing season will start from June, with the arrival of the monsoon. “It is a welcome move and India will benefit in terms of getting supplies of raw materials, gas, intermediaries

such as phosphoric acid and sulphuric acid and fine products like DAP and urea from supplier countries,” said an industry official. Though the concern over the global high price will remain for some time, it will ease immediately when supplies improve, he said, adding that to what extent the fall will be depends on crude oil prices. **TO CURB SPECULATION** Commenting on the ceasefire, PS Gahlaut, Managing Director of Indian Potash Ltd(IPL), said the company remains focused on strengthening supply preparedness through timely imports and efficient distribution across States, ensuring fertilizer availability. “The ceasefire is a timely and positive development as



SLOW AND STEADY. The impact on price reduction might be gradual, say industry experts

it is expected to improve LNG availability from the Gulf and support uninterrupted fertilizer supplies ahead of the kharif sowing. Since natural gas is the key feedstock for urea production and India remains significantly dependent on imported LNG, this will help stabilise domestic produc-

tion, ease import-related cost pressures and curb speculative price increase,” said Gahlaut. The development also offers relief on the subsidy front and strengthens overall supply-chain confidence for the fertilizer sector, he said. IPL, on behalf of the gov-

ernment, on April 4 floated a global tender to import 2.5 million tonnes (mt) of urea, the highest quantity ever in a single bid by the government, and it is to be opened on April 15. It specified that after the loading of urea, the vessels should start sailing from the load-port before June 15, potentially helping India to receive the crop nutrient before July 31. The government also announced on Wednesday that the supply of LNG to urea plants will be increased to 95 per cent of their last six months’ average consumption. On Monday, it announced that units had started receiving 90 per cent of their LNG requirement. According to Chirag Jain, Partner-Agri and Allied Sector, Grant Thornton Bharat,

India’s fertilizer economy remains deeply embedded in global supply chains. Things have become much more critical and volatile with the ongoing West Asia crises as the Gulf region accounts for 20-30 per cent of India’s urea requirement and 30 per cent of DAP imports, and also supplies nearly 50 per cent of India’s LNG imports. Jain termed the Cabinet’s approval on Wednesday for ₹41,500 crore fertilizer subsidy for kharif 2026 as a prudent and timely measure to mitigate the cascading impact of supply disruptions and price volatility arising from the West Asia conflict. “By ensuring the continued availability of key fertilizers at stable prices, the decision safeguards farmers’ input affordability during the critical kharif season,” he said.

COMMODITY

CALL.

Copper futures: Go long at ₹1,184, stop-loss at ₹1,140



Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Copper futures, which have been in a sideways trend recently, broke out of a barrier in early trade on Wednesday. This has opened the door for a further rally. The April contract, now trading at ₹1,184 (per kg), was charting a sideways trend in the narrow range of ₹1,140-1,170. A breakout of the upper boundary is a bullish signal. Substantiating the bullish bias, the price has now risen above the 21-day moving average, and the contract has breached a trendline resistance. So, in the near-term, we can expect copper futures to surpass the potential hurdle at ₹1,200 and move up to ₹1,250. On the other hand, if copper futures falls from the current level, it can find support at ₹1,140. A breach of this can turn the outlook weak and drag the contract to ₹1,100. However, as it stands, the probability for a rally is high. **TRADE STRATEGY** Last week, we suggested going short on copper futures (April) at ₹1,180 with a stop-loss at ₹1,215 for a target of ₹1,070. Exit this trade now as the outlook has turned positive. Buy copper futures (April) now at ₹1,184. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,250 and ₹1,140 respectively.

Pegged lower at 4.03 lt, coffee output may weigh on exports in current fiscal

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

After achieving record exports in FY26, a weaker crop in the 2025-26 coffee year (ending September) is likely to temper export momentum in the current fiscal, as tighter supplies may weigh on shipment volumes. A higher crop and robust demand led to record export volumes of over 4.07 lakh tonnes (lt) during FY26, with shipments exceeding \$2.136 billion in value. “The crop size this year is going to be a major factor. We expect the arabica output to be around 90,000 tonnes, about 10,000 tonnes more than last year, while the robusta production is seen 40,000-50,000 tonnes less than last year,” said Ramesh Rajah, President, Coffee Ex-



PAST GLORY. A higher crop and robust demand led to record export volumes of over 4.07 lt during FY26

porters Association. For the current coffee year 2025-26 (October-September), the Coffee Board, in its initial or post blossom estimates, pegged the output at 4.03 lt, comprising 1.18 lt of arabica and 2.84 lt of robusta, which the stakeholders felt was on the higher side. The Board is yet to release the final production figures for 2025-26. During 2024-25, India

produced 1.057 lt of arabica and 2.578 lt of robusta, totalling 3.63 lt, as per the Board’s final estimate. Sahadev Balakrishna, Chairman, UPASI Coffee Committee, said the arabica output for 2025-26 was slightly better than last year, while robusta production had seen a decline. “Arabica output may be close to 1 lt, above previous year’s 80,000-90,000 tonnes, while

robusta production may be in the range of 2.5-2.6 lt.”

PREMIUM A CHALLENGE Factors, such as poor crop setting and excess rain, impacted the output during 2025-26. Prolonged monsoon rain impacted the crop in some key growing areas such as Karnataka and Kerala. M Salmaan Baseer, Chairman, Karnataka Planters Association, estimated the crop size of arabica at around 80,000 tonnes and robusta at 2.75 lt. Besides a lower crop size, the high premiums that Indian coffees are commanding could pose a challenge to exports. With premiums for Ugandan coffee rising, the African producer has emerged as a competitor to Indian robusta in the European market, especially Italy, Rajah said.

Agri-input industry flags ‘Inspector Raj’ return in Maharashtra, urges State to retain reforms

Our Bureau
Pune

Leading industry bodies representing India’s agri-input and fertilizer sector have urged Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis to retain the State’s inspector-free regulatory regime, warning that any move to reintroduce an inspection-heavy system could hurt investor sentiment and ease of doing business. The Indian Micro Fertilizers Manufacturers Association (IMMA), along with the Soluble Fertilizer Industry Association (SFIA), the Pesticides Manufacturers & Formulators Association of India (PMFAI), the Organic Agro Manufacturers Association (OAMA), the Maharashtra Biocontrol Manufacturers Association (MBMA) and the Indian



Agro Inputs Manufacturers Association (IAIM) have jointly expressed concern over reports suggesting the possible return of an inspection-heavy regulatory regime. The industry pointed out that Maharashtra became the first State to roll out an inspector-free regime through a government resolution issued in June 2025. The reform, they said, was widely welcomed for promoting a trust-based compliance model, improving

transparency and supporting MSMEs in the agri-input sector. According to the associations, the existing framework had encouraged responsible manufacturing practices, boosted investment in crop nutrition solutions, and contributed to agricultural productivity and farmer incomes. **CONCERNS RAISED** However, the bodies flagged recent deliberations, reportedly held in October 2025 and January 2026, on reintroducing an inspector-driven system. They noted that such discussions took place without adequate consultation with key industry stakeholders. Industry representatives cautioned that reinstating an inspection-heavy regime could increase regulatory discretion, compliance bur-

dens, and operational uncertainty for manufacturers and importers. Some also attributed the push to a “residual inspector lobby” seeking to regain oversight powers. They urged the State government to withdraw any proposal that may lead to the return of what they termed “Inspector Raj”, and instead continue with policies that prioritise the ease of doing business, accountability and sectoral growth. Vijay Thakur of the OAM Association Maharashtra stated that the June 19, 2025, government resolution was a bold and overdue dismantling of ‘Inspector Raj’, restoring trust and enabling genuine industry growth. Any attempt to revert to an inspection-heavy regime would be a serious setback, reopening the door to corruption, extortion and regulatory misuse, he said.

Make India self-sufficient in pulses, oilseeds: Shivraj Chouhan to farmers

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan has said there is a need to achieve total self-sufficiency in food and assured that the government would ensure this so that India does not have to import any food item. Currently, the import dependency on edible oils is about 55 per cent whereas in pulses it went from 8 per cent in 2022-23 to 21 per cent in 2024-25. “If food security is to be ensured, we need to be self-sufficient in pulses and oilseeds. There should not be any food item which requires import from overseas,” Chouhan said in Jaipur. Inaugurating a regional agriculture conference, he said under the Pulses Mission launched by the Centre,



Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan

all States have been directed to maximise seed production to ensure availability of quality seeds to farmers. Financial assistance is being provided for seed production — ₹4,500 per quintal for tur (pigeon pea), ₹2,000 per quintal for urad and ₹1,800 per quintal for gram. State-wise targets for subsidised seed distribution have also been set — 3,10,870 quintals for Madhya Pradesh, 2,45,000 quintals for Rajasthan, 87,500 quintals

for Maharashtra, and 40,000 quintals for Gujarat. Special emphasis is being placed on rapidly bringing new pulse varieties into the seed chain, with 79 varieties identified in Rajasthan, 58 in Gujarat, 63 in Madhya Pradesh and 58 in Maharashtra. **MODEL DISTRICTS** Highlighting that Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Rajasthan and Gujarat together contribute over 60 per cent of the country’s pulses production, he said districts like Narmadapuram (Madhya Pradesh) and Tonk (Rajasthan), which are performing exceptionally well, will be developed as model districts. “Provision has also been made for 100 per cent subsidised seed distribution from willing farmers at MSP, ensuring income security similar to wheat and rice,” he said.

Icrisat, PJTAU to improve soil health in Telangana

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Telangana government has tied up with the International Crops Research Institute for Semi-Arid Tropics (Icrisat) and Professor Jayashankar Telangana Agricultural University (PJTAU) to help improve soil health. The organisations will help the government build a skilled workforce capable of conveying the message to farmers across the State. While Icrisat held a training session for over 120 farmers and other ecosystem stakeholders on soil health management this week, the university enrolled over 1,000 volunteers in a capacity-building programme held on Wednesday. **TRAINING VOLUNTEERS** Icrisat’s programme focused on equipping farmers with

tools, knowledge and advisory support to improve soil health, optimise input use and promote crop diversification. “Advancing soil health depends on capacity building, partnerships, policy alignment and effective knowledge transfer. Soil health management must move from being a recommendation to becoming a practice at scale,” Himanshu Pathak, Director-General, Icrisat, said in a release on Tuesday. PJTAU Vice-Chancellor Aldas Janaiah said the University had decided to train over 30,000 soil health volunteers for promotion of soil health. “We will train at least 2-3 volunteers in every village in soil health management over the next two months. They will be trained in conducting soil health tests, preparation of soil health cards and reports,” he said.

MMTC-PAMP launches buyback offer for silver coins, bars, jewellery

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

MMTC-PAMP, a London Bullion Market Association (LBMA) Good Delivery gold and silver refiner, has launched an organised buyback offering for silver coins, bars and jewellery. MMTC-PAMP plans to offer this service at select retail stores across India. MMTC-PAMP, which operates 17 stores for the recycling of gold in India, aims to extend its buyback offering for silver across these centres. In the first phase of the launch of the project, MMTC-PAMP will commence silver recycling at select exclusive brand stores / purity verification stores in Kolkata, Bhubaneswar, Guwahati, Ludhiana, Ahmedabad, Mumbai and



New Delhi. The company plans to expand this service across all its stores across India in the next fiscal. **AVAILING THE OFFER** Quoting Sanit Guha, Managing Director and CEO of MMTC-PAMP, a media statement said Indian households collectively hold approximately 35,000 tonnes of gold and much more silver. While the silver mine production capacity globally is not expanding significantly, the demand for the

white metal seems to be growing at a much faster rate. “Given the current scenario, we expect recycled silver to play a key role in meeting the current supply-demand gap,” Guha said. To avail themselves of MMTC-PAMP’s silver buyback process, consumers can visit the company’s Purity Verification Centre and verify their silver products. Bars, coins and jewellery will be melted and then tested under XRF technology, the industry standard for precise purity, under security surveillance. After the necessary documentation for refining and buyback is completed, the silver will be valued based on the best market buyback rate and an instant payout will be initiated to the customer’s designated bank account, the statement said.

QUICKLY.

Cycle Agarbathi acquires majority stake in Satvik

Bengaluru: Incense major Cycle Pure Agarbathi has acquired a majority stake in pooja accessories brand Satvik, marking a strategic pivot into the fast-growing spiritual and devotional products segment. The deal, financial details undisclosed, gives Cycle access to Satvik's differentiated portfolio of prayer and ritual products. The partnership also opens up export opportunities, with Cycle present in 75 countries and planning to take Satvik's products to global markets. **OUR BUREAU**

BonV Aero begins work on ₹300 crore UAV facility

Mumbai: Drone manufacturing start-up BonV Aero said it has started preparatory work for its ₹300 crore unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) facility at Khordha in Odisha, where an advanced assembly line, a centre of excellence and a drone park will be set up. The new facility, spanning 2.5 acres, is designed as an integrated UAV hub. **PTI**

EC replaces TN Chief Secretary ahead of polls



Chennai: Election Commission of India has directed the Tamil Nadu government to appoint senior bureaucrat M Sai Kumar as the State's chief secretary in place of N Muruganandam. The Commission also directed the Chief Secretary to appoint senior IPS officer Sandeep Mittal as Director General of Police (Armed Police and Vigilance and Anti-Corruption). **OUR BUREAU**

CCEA approves higher cost, equity infusion for HPCL Rajasthan Refinery

INFRA PUSH. Two hydro electric projects in the North-East were also approved by the Cabinet Committee

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Ahead of its scheduled inauguration by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on April 21, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) on Wednesday approved escalated cost of around ₹73,000 crore and additional equity infusion of around ₹9,000 crore by HPCL in HPCL Rajasthan Refinery Ltd (HRRL).

The CCEA approved two hydro power projects in the North-East, while the Cabinet gave its nod to the second phase of Jaipur Metro.

RAJASTHAN REFINERY

The original cost of the Rajasthan refinery was ₹43,129 crore, which has now gone up around 69 per cent. The CCEA approved raising equity investment by HPCL by ₹8,962 crore to ₹19,600 crore. The project was conceived in 2008 and was ini-



LONG WAIT. The HPCL Rajasthan Refinery project was conceived in 2008 and was initially approved in 2013

tially approved in 2013; it was reconfigured and work commencement was done in 2018 by the Prime Minister, with a target to start operations by December 2022. However, according to officials, the pandemic affected the construction work and cost of various materials increased, thereby resulting in cost escalation. Now, the construction is complete.

“The scheduled commercial operation date is July 1, 2026,” an official statement said. The HRRL refinery is

highly complex, with more than 26 per cent petrochemical product slate. Together with production of 1 mtpa (million tonnes per annum) of petrol, 4 mtpa of diesel, it would produce 1 mtpa of Polypropylene, 0.5 mtpa of LLPDE (Linear Low-Density Polyethylene), 0.5 mtpa of HDPE (High Density Polyethylene) and about 0.4 mtpa of Benzene, Toluene and Butadiene.

“All these products are critical to our energy and industrial ecosystem in sectors

such as transportation, pharma, paints, packaging industries, etc. The project will lead to energy independence and reduce import-dependence of the petrochemical sector,” the statement said. The Centre and State together will get around ₹21,000 crore every year.

JAIPUR METRO

There was another important development for Rajasthan, as the Cabinet approved the second phase of Jaipur Metro. The 41-km-long North-South corridor from Prahladpura to Toddi Mod in the Pink City will have 36 stations, to be developed at a cost of over ₹13,000 crore. The project will be implemented by Rajasthan Metro Rail Corporation, a 50:50 joint venture of the Government of India and the Rajasthan government. Currently, Jaipur Metro Phase-1 records an average daily ridership of around 60,000 passengers on the

shorter, but critical, 11.64-km corridor.

HYDRO POWER

Meanwhile, the CCEA approved investment of ₹14,105.83 crore for the construction of Kalai-II Hydro Electric Project on Lohit River in Anjaw district of Arunachal Pradesh. The estimated completion period for the project is 78 months. The project, with an installed capacity of 1,200 MW, is expected to generate 4,852.95 MU of energy annually. It will be implemented through a joint venture company between THDC India and the Government of Arunachal Pradesh.

The second hydro power project, which got approved, involved investment of over ₹26,000 crore for the construction of Kamala Hydro Electric Project in Kamle, Kra Daadi and Kurung Kumey districts of Arunachal Pradesh. The estimated completion period for the project is 96 months.



India's solar energy capacity crosses 150 GW

M Ramesh
Chennai

India's installed solar power capacity has crossed the 150 GW mark, numbers put out by the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy show. This happened as installations in March reached a record 6.65 GW. In the full year 2025-26, India's solar installations were 44.61 GW, taking the cumulative capacity to 150.26 GW.

There has been another notable record — in wind power. India installed a record 6.05 GW of wind power capacity, the highest ever, surpassing the 2016-17 record of 5.2 GW. Yet another record achieved in 2025-26 is the total renewable energy capacity installations crossing the 50 GW mark. Total installations during the year were 50.9 GW. With this, India's total renewable energy installed capacity, excluding large hydro, stands at 223.27 GW. Including large hydro (51.41 GW), the number is 283.46 GW.

Also noteworthy is the point that within solar, rooftop installations crossed

the 25-GW mark; they now stand at 25.73 GW.

INSTALLED CAPACITY

Minister for New and Renewable Energy and Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution

Pralhad Joshi said on Wednesday that India ranks third globally in renewable energy installed capacity. “Distributed renewable energy (DRE) from solar has emerged as a significant component of this growth, contributing 16.3 GW (36 per cent) of the 44.61 GW installed during 2025-26,” said a MNRE press release. This includes 7.6 GW under PM KUSUM and 8.7 GW from rooftop solar. Non-fossil capacity addition in 2025-26 is 55.29 GW and this is the highest increase in any year. Previously, the highest increase was 29.5 GW during 2024-25, the release said.

In FY27, power sector may consume up to 850 mt of coal; sufficient stocks available

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Coal-based thermal power plants (TPPs) with an installed capacity of over 221 gigawatts (GW) are likely to consume up to 850 million tonnes (mt) of coal in the current financial year, ending March 2027, against a demand of 906 mt.

The Power Ministry communicated a demand of 906 mt for FY26 to the Coal Ministry, of which TPPs consumed around 813 mt.

This reduced consumption was largely due to lower power demand on account of

lower-than-expected Summer temperatures and growing supply from renewable energy sources (RES).

“In FY27 as well, the Power Ministry has made a demand for 906 mt. However, considering the generation from RES, the expectation is that real consumption in this fiscal will be below 850 mt. This is even after factoring in higher Summer temperatures for May-July,” explained sources. As per projections of Central Electricity Authority (CEA), the peak solar and non-solar demand in FY27 is expected to be around 289 GW and 265 GW, respectively.



STOCK IN HAND. Coal stocks at TPPs stand at 55.18 mt as on April 6, sufficient for about 24 days based on recent consumption

Speaking at the daily inter-ministerial briefing on West Asia on Wednesday, Sanjeev Kumar Kassi, Joint Secretary in Coal Ministry, said in the current geopolitical situation, the coal sector carries

greater responsibility and stands fully prepared to meet consumer needs, supported by the Indian Railways and adequate coal stocks at mines and thermal power plants.

Coal stocks at TPPs stand at 55.18 mt as on April 6, sufficient for about 24 days based on recent consumption. In addition, about 171.90 mt is available at mines and in transit, including stocks at Coal India (CIL), Singareni Collieries Company (SCCL), captive mines, ports and transit, Kassi said.

MAINTAINING SUPPLY

“CIL and SCCL have absorbed higher input costs, including increased prices of explosives and diesel, without passing them on to consumers,” he noted.

To ensure affordability

and availability, CIL reduced the reserve price of coal by 20 per cent under e-auctions and increased supply through e-auctions and the State-nominated agency mechanism. Coal supply for small, medium and other consumers has been optimised through these two channels, with higher allocations to meet emergent and short-term requirements, Kassi added.

CIL increased the frequency of e-auctions in March 2026, offering 32.53 mt of coal, of which 13.32 mt, about 40.94 per cent, was booked, indicating adequate supply. For April 2026, 30 e-

auctions have been planned offering 25.80 mt; so far, 3.20 mt have been offered and 1.24 mt booked, about 38.75 per cent.

The ministry has advised State governments to submit demand in a timely manner and to prevent profiteering and hoarding, while ensuring fair distribution. Coal off-take by State-nominated agencies is being monitored daily.

The annual average off-take for FY26 stood at 14.26 per cent against allocation, with States permitted to lift the remaining allocation within 90 days beyond March 31, 2026.

BEL kickstarts Uttar Pradesh defence venture with 75 ha land allotment, invests ₹562 crore

Our Bureau
New Delhi

State-owned Bharat Electronics' (BEL) over ₹562 crore investment in the Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor (UPDIC) rolled out on Wednesday with the allotment of 75 hectares in the Chitrakoot node to begin production of defence systems.

“Under this project, Bharat Electronics will establish an advanced manufacturing unit for the production of state-of-the-art radar and air defence systems with an investment of approximately ₹562.5 crore,” Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said.

The UPDIC has attracted over ₹34,000 crore in investments, with ₹12,000 crore already disbursed across six nodes covering Aligarh, Agra, Jhansi, Kanpur, Chitrakoot and Lucknow.

As per officials, at least 62 industries have been allot-

ted land across the six nodes for production and testing facilities.

They include BrahMos Aerospace, Adani Defence and Aerospace, Aerolloy Technologies, Werywin Defence, Nitya Creations, Sankalp Safety and Amitec Electronics.

Adityanath handed over the land allotment letter to BEL Chairman and Managing Director Manoj Jain for establishing the production facility in the Chitrakoot node, which has better logistics connectivity and geographical suitability.

‘NEW AVENUES’

“This initiative will play an important role in establishing Uttar Pradesh as a strong and reliable identity in the field of defence manufacturing, while also accelerating the overall economic and industrial development of the Bundelkhand region,” Adityanath said.



Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath

It will not only strengthen high technology-based production in the defence sector, but also provide a new direction to the expansion of industrial efficiency and technical capabilities in the State, an official statement said.

Consequently, there is a possibility of generating more than 300 direct employment opportunities, while large-scale indirect employment will also be created in ancillary and allied sectors, opening new avenues for local youth,

Adityanath said.

According to him, the move will significantly reduce migration to other regions for jobs as well as strengthen the regional economy and institutionally promote the development of technically-skilled human resources, research and innovation.

In the process, it will lead to the creation of a modern industrial ecosystem in the State.

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Ola Electric to roll out battery cells developed in-house from next quarter

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Ola Electric Mobility on Tuesday said it has developed an in-house lithium iron phosphate (LFP) battery cell in the 46100 cylindrical format. It will begin deploying the same in its vehicles from the next quarter as it sharpens its focus on lowering costs and accelerating EV adoption.

The announcement, made through regulatory filings to the stock exchanges, marks a strategic shift from the nickel manganese cobalt chemistry currently used in its vehicles to LFP, widely seen as safer and more cost-efficient, particularly for high-temperature markets like India.

Chief Financial Officer Deepak Rastogi confirmed that the cells are ready for commercial rollout, with Ola building on learnings from its earlier cell programme. The cells will be manufactured at its gigafactory, which currently has a capacity of 2.5 GWh and is being scaled up to 6 GWh, according to the filing.

PLI SCHEME

This positions the company to benefit from government incentives under the production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for advanced chemistry cells. The move also deepens Ola's vertical integration strategy.

Analysts said the shift to LFP could help Ola better align with Indian operating conditions.

YOGAKSHEMAM LOANS LIMITED
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COLD AUCTION NOTICE
The borrowers, in specific and the public, in general, are hereby notified that public auction of the gold ornaments of pledged in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted at the following branches on **28.04.2026** from 10 a.m. onwards. We are auctioning gold ornaments of defaulted customers who have failed to make payment of his/her loan amount despite being notified by registered letters. Unauctioned items shall be auctioned on any other days without further notice. Changes in venue or date (if any) will be displayed at auction centre and on website without any further notice. List of Pledges:
COIMBATORE: 210107108572, 8868, 9221, 9222, 9485, ERODE: 210105105812, 5813, 6739, 6900, 7356, KARUR: 210103109162, 9068, 9069, 9077, 9078, THIRUPUR: 210108118981, 9798, 9799, 9817, 9894, 9911, 9963, 9964, DHARMAPUR: 2101171792, 7975, 9354, 9355, 9425, 9503, 9504, 9505, 9506, 9507, 9513, 9519, 9541, 9542, 9554, 9555, 9582, 9601, 9630, 9639, 9640, 9647, 9660, 9680, 9688, 9689, 9754, 9768, 9769, 9776, 9809, 9827, 9836, 9837, 210117120205, 0240, 0311, 0607, KANNIYAKUMARI: 210116103900, 3901, 3902, 3947, 3951, 3952, 3966, 4056, 4057, 4058, 4081, 4089, 4090, 4099, 4100, 4108, 4110, 4263, 4400, 4648, 4751, MANGALAM: 210119103687, 3781, 3782, 3786, 3787, 3824, 3844, 3845, 3846, 3947, 3971, 4443, PALAKKAD: 210106107607, 0853, 0854, 0840, 0841, 0854, 0855, 0861, 7386, 7442, 7535, 7688, 7699, PATTANAM: 210115105464, 5515, 6452, 6518, 6525, 6535, 6565, 6566, 6581, 6589, 6599, 6611, 6617, 6619, 6627, 6628, 6632, 6633, 6659, 6698, 6747, 6748, 6754, 6783, 6784, 6797, 6798, 6801, 6802, 6804, 6805, 6823, 6824, 6835, 6856, 6857, 6838, 6842, 6861, 7500, 7818, PANNIYAN: 210105112267, 1227, 2297, 2299, 2798, 2830, 2846, 2847, 2856, SILEM: 210113109746, 9747, 9774, 9775, 9779, 9780, 9834, 9836, 9840, 210113110097, BARGUR: 210107106181, 6278, 7639, 7698, 7699, 7715, 7724, 7740, 7741, 7824, 7825, 7832, 7833, 7904, 7905, 7926, 7995, 7996, 8020, 8382, DENKANIKOTTA: 210114103796, 3798, 4762, 4775, 4776, 4820, 4821, 4830, 4845, 4869, 4870, 4903, 4907, 4913, 4957, 4999, 5000, 5007, 5020, 5095, 5094, 5194, 5231, 5489, 5547, HOSUR: 210116108223, 8296, 8987, 9001, 9002, 9040, 9159, 9160, 9161, 9173, 9174, 9207, 9210, 9211, 9212, 9213, 9216, 9440, KAVERPATTANAM: 210190105508, 3509, 4909, 4910, 5011, 5012, 5044, 5051, 5052, 5088, 5089, 5092, 5183, 5215, 5260, 5390, 5446, KIRIEMANGALAM: 210194102856, 2857, 3869, 3984, 3985, 4043, 4044, 4127, 4128, PERIYAMPATTI: 210178106110, 6111, 7557, 7563, 7603, 7609, 7610, 7655, 7656, 7671, 7673, 7683, 7685, 7689, 7695, 7708, 7718, 7719, 7763, 7764, 7794, 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769

QUICKLY.

Max Health buys ₹300-cr stake in Kalinga Hospital



Mumbai: Max Healthcare has entered into a share purchase agreement to acquire a controlling stake in Kalinga Hospital Ltd (KHL) from the Hospital Corporation of Orissa, strengthening its presence in the eastern region. Max will acquire 58.4 per cent stake in KHL at ₹300 crore, Max Healthcare said. The 250-bed NABH-accredited hospital is at Maitri Vihar, Bhubaneswar, it added. Spread over 2,60,000 sq ft, the hospital provides services across specialties, including neurology, cardiology, orthopaedics, gastroenterology, renal sciences and oncology. OUR BUREAU

Cyient Semicon buys 74% stake in Kinetic Tech



Hyderabad: Cyient Semiconductors, an arm of Cyient, has acquired 74 per cent stake in Kinetic Technologies, a US-based semiconductor solutions company, for a consideration of \$85 million. “The completion of this majority stake investment accelerates our ambition to build a globally competitive semiconductor innovation engine from India,” Suman Narayan, CEO of Cyient Semiconductors, said on Wednesday. Kinetic Technologies will continue to operate under its current leadership. OUR BUREAU

SEZs say DTA duty relief ‘too narrow’, see little benefit for 80% of supplies

CONCESSIONS SOUGHT. Council urges wider coverage, higher 50% cap, longer tenure and procedural easing

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



EXCLUSION. According to the Export Promotion Council's analysis, a majority of goods manufactured in SEZs fall outside the categories that effectively benefit from the concessional duty structure, limiting its practical utility. BUJOY GHOSH

Special Economic Zone (SEZ) units have criticised the government's recent tax concessions for Domestic Tariff Area (DTA) sales (sales in the domestic market), citing data that shows the policy may not benefit as much as 80 per cent of the supplies. In a formal presentation to the Commerce Department recently on ease of doing business problems, the Export Promotion Council for EOUs and SEZs also sought the concession for a longer period of 2-3 years and a higher cap of 50 per cent instead of 30 per cent (annual exports recorded in any of the three immediately preceding financial years). “Industry representatives argued that the current

framework was a welcome step towards easing restrictions on SEZ units selling in the domestic market, but remained too narrow in scope to deliver meaningful relief,” a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

‘NOT ENOUGH’ The government had recently allowed SEZ units to sell goods in the DTA at con-

cessional duty rates — a long-standing demand aimed at improving utilisation levels and providing flexibility amid weak global demand. However, the relief was introduced only as a one-time measure, restricted to a single fiscal year, and carried a strict cap that limited such sales to 30 per cent of the highest annual exports re-

corded in any of the three immediately preceding financial years.

PRODUCTIVITY HIT According to the council's analysis, a majority of goods manufactured in SEZs fall outside the categories that effectively benefit from the concessional duty structure, limiting its practical utility. “The present concessions cover only a small subset of products and transactions, leaving nearly 80 per cent of supplies without any tangible advantage. Moreover, about 13 per cent of DTA supplies get a marginal 1 per cent duty concession,” the source said. “Without broader coverage and more concessions, the measure risks being largely symbolic.” Units maintain that the existing cap on such sales, along with the limited duration of the concession, con-

strains their ability to plan production and inventory efficiently. “The council has recommended that the permissible limit for concessional DTA sales be raised to 50 per cent, from the current lower threshold of 30 per cent, and that the policy be extended for at least two to three years to provide certainty. It also flagged the need for clearer guidelines to avoid procedural delays at customs,” the source said. The process of taking certificates from DCs (development commissioners) for meeting various conditions has to be streamlined and made industry friendly, the council said in its presentation. It suggested that the requirement should be one time rather than on each shipping bill and also sought online facility for outlying SEZ units.



Vijay Singh, Tata Trusts trustee, received over ₹20 cr as commission, fees

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Vijay Singh, Trustee, Tata Trusts

Tata Trusts trustee Vijay Singh is understood to have received a little over ₹20 crore as sitting fees and commission on the boards of various Tata group companies, including Tata Sons, according to documents seen by *businessline*. The commissions received by him pertain to the period from FY14 to FY25. The fees received by Singh as a nominee director on the boards of the companies should have gone to the charitable trusts if good governance practices were followed. However, according to sources aware of the matter, the fees paid to Singh were retained by him. Apart from Tata Sons, the companies' boards on which he was a nominee director include Tata Advanced Systems, Tata Lockheed Martin Aerospace and Tata Sikorsky Aerospace. Singh, a former Defence Secretary, was ousted from

the board of Tata Sons in late 2025, with a faction of trustees led by Mehli Mistry voting against him. More recently, Mistry has challenged Singh's (and another trustee Venu Srinivasan's) positions as trustees of Bai Hiraabai Jamsetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution on the grounds that they did not meet the eligibility criteria of being a permanent resident of Mumbai and following the Parsi Zoroastrian faith. While Srinivasan resigned from the trust immediately, Vijay Singh continues to hold his position.

World Bank cuts India's FY27 growth rate by 30 bps to 6.6%

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



Elevated global energy prices will pinch households' disposable income. GETTY IMAGES

The World Bank on Wednesday revised India's growth forecast up by 30 basis points (bps) to 6.6 per cent for fiscal year 2026-27. “Growth is projected to decelerate to 6.6 per cent in FY27, reflecting headwinds from the West Asia conflict,” World Bank said in the latest South Asia Economic Update, ‘Working with Industrial Policy’. “Other forecasters have revised down their growth projections to a range between 5.9 and 6.7 per cent,” it said. The World Bank's forecast for the current fiscal is lower than RBI's 6.9 per cent. The World Bank pegged

the growth at 7.6 per cent for FY26, higher than 7.1 per cent of FY25. This is mainly on account of strong domestic demand and export resilience. “Private consumption growth was particularly robust, supported by low inflation and rationalisation of the Goods and Services Tax (GST),” it added. **ENERGY PRICES** Elevated global energy prices are expected to put upward pressure on prices and constrain households' disposable income. “Government consumption growth is expected to soften to offset higher subsidy outlays for cooking fuel and fertilizers,” the Bank said, while adding that investment growth is likely to

moderate amid elevated uncertainty and rising input costs. “Improved access to the US and the European Union for India's exports will be undermined by slower growth in major trading partners,” it added. Updated GDP data and

calculation methods revealed that the economy was slightly smaller than previously thought, but recent growth has been faster. **STRONG CONSUMPTION** Domestic demand has been strong, with robust retail sales and consumer confidence reaching its highest post-pandemic level in November 2025. According to the report, recent reforms to simplify and reduce taxes have also supported private consumption. Domestic strength outweighed goods export weakness. Goods exports grew by only 0.1 per cent in 2025, due to the US' brief imposition of 50 per cent tariffs. Services exports grew by about 16 per cent from

December to February. Foreign investors, alongside strong remittances, helped contain the current account deficit. Falling food prices kept inflation below the Central bank's 2-6 per cent target from September to December, before it rose to 3.2 per cent in February. The report said that South Asia growth is expected to slow to 6.3 per cent in 2026 — from 7 per cent in 2025 — due to disruptions in global energy markets. “Despite the near-term slowdown, South Asia continues to grow faster than other emerging-market and developing economies,” the report said. The growth outlook is driven primarily by India's performance, it added.

Corporate governance must empower people, says Arundhati Bhattacharya

Our Bureau
Mumbai

At an event where corporate governance was viewed through the lens of dharma, service and responsibility, Padma Shri awardee Arundhati Bhattacharya offered a grounded view: Governance, she said, is about how institutions empower people through everyday decisions that make work and life more human. Speaking at the ‘Dharmam Chara’ programme at the BSE, the President and Chief Executive Officer of Sales-force South Asia said governance is not just a set of rules, but a reflection of choices made within organisations. “Values are not posters on walls. They are the decisions you make when no one's watching,” she said. She drew on her own journey from a modest back-

ground to leadership roles in major institutions as an example of how support systems can shape outcomes. Empowerment, she suggested, begins in small but consequential ways, in the flexibility given to employees, the policies that help families cope, and the culture that allows people to stay productive without losing their humanity. “Dharma is a practice, not a destination. Values are lived, not proclaimed. Empowerment is action, not aspiration,” she said, drawing a direct link between ethical intent and organisational behaviour. Bhattacharya illustrated this through decisions taken during her tenure as Chairperson of the State Bank of India. Moving from a six-day work week to two Saturdays off each month and introducing a two-year sabbatical policy were, in her telling, governance interventions as

much as HR reforms. By addressing childcare and eldercare challenges, these policies sought to remove structural barriers that often force employees, particularly women, out of the workforce. The underlying idea is that governance frameworks are meaningful only when they translate into enabling systems for employees, she said. **BUSINESS WITH RESPONSIBILITY** That principle extends to corporate social responsibility. She contrasted traditional CSR, often seen as “writing checks,” with approaches that embed responsibility into business models. Citing Salesforce's “1-1-1 model”, she described governance as aligning capital, products and employee time with community outcomes. “When you practice dharma consistently, you



(from left) Shankaracharya of Kanchi Kamakoti Peetam Sri Shankara Vijayendra Saraswathi Swamikal; Sundararaman Ramamurthy, MD & CEO, BSE; and KR Sekar, Deloitte Private Family Enterprise Leader, Deloitte Asia Pacific, at the event

don't pick and choose who deserves to be enabled. You enable everyone,” she said. “Dharma is weaving the act of enabling into the fabric of how one operates every single day.” R Shankar Raman, Whole-time Director and CFO of Larsen & Toubro, echoed

this through a more operational lens. He said the company's CSR efforts were anchored around communities near its project sites, factories and offices, an approach that ties governance directly to local impact. “It was a perfect example of mutuality and interde-

pendence,” he said. “It not only gave us an opportunity to tap into the resources of the neighbouring community but it also helped us and gave us a chance to promote their livelihood.” Governance is not just about oversight, but about integrating “service” into business decisions, he said. **BEYOND NUMBERS** M Damodaran, former Chairman of the Securities and Exchange Board of India, said governance must extend its lens beyond balance sheets. He cautioned against equating development solely with physical infrastructure. “Of course, we need these. But far more important is social infrastructure, better education, healthcare and all that improves the quality of life,” he said. The Shankaracharya of Kanchi Kamakoti Peetam, Sri Shankara Vijayendra Saraswathi Swamikal, said

that while business can embody dharma, it should not reduce it to a transaction. He added, “Business can have dharma. Dharma cannot be equated with business.” He also said that independence would be meaningful only if dharma is safeguarded, particularly as India enters a phase of economic and institutional stability. If there was a common thread through the discussions, it was the idea that governance is not static. It evolves through policies, leadership choices and institutional intent, and is ultimately measured by its impact on people. Bhattacharya summed it up in a simple daily test — whether one has enabled or empowered someone. In corporate terms, that question may well define the next phase of governance — one that moves from compliance to consequence.

Travel demand for Dubai should return to normalcy in six months: IHCL

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Travel demand to Dubai should return to normalcy in the next five to six months, but room rates will take longer to recover, Indian Hotels Company Ltd (IHCL) Managing Director and CEO Puneet Chhatwal said on Wednesday. IHCL operates three hotels under the Taj brand in Dubai, and these have seen a demand dip following the outbreak of the West Asia conflict in end-February.

OCCUPANCY FALLS Industry-wide occupancies in Dubai fell from 80 per cent to 20-30 per cent. “We should be in a fine place by September-October,” Chhatwal said at the Hotel Investment Conference South Asia event in Mumbai. Summer months are generally a slow season for Dubai, and rates tend to be lower than other periods of the year. With demand impacted now, rate recovery would take longer, he said.

DOMESTIC DEMAND Domestic business remains strong, and Chhatwal said he believes that it could actually benefit due to the West Asia conflict. Airfares have surged as airlines levy a fuel surcharge to recover costs, and this is impacting demand in long-haul markets. “Within the Middle East there are many sub-markets. Saudi Arabia market is dependent on domestic demand and so hotels in the country were impacted less than those in Dubai. However, if the crisis lasts longer, the hospitality industry in the entire region will get affected,” said Jester Palmqvist, Regional Vice-President of STR, a real estate data insights firm.

Global semicon revenue to cross \$1.3 trillion in 2026: Gartner

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Global semiconductor revenue is projected to exceed \$1.3 trillion in 2026, exhibiting the highest growth in the last two decades, according to Gartner. “Amid high demand for AI processing, data centre networking and power, and memory price inflation (memflation), the semiconductor industry is projected to achieve a third consecutive year of double-digit growth in 2026, a milestone that underscores the sector's pivotal role in the AI technology stack,” said Rajeev Rajput, Senior Principal Analyst at Gartner. Gartner forecasts semiconductor revenue to grow 64 per cent in 2026, with memory revenue expected to increase three-fold amid memflation. It estimates



Gartner forecasts semiconductor revenue to grow 64 per cent in 2026. GETTY IMAGES

DRAM and NAND flash annual prices in 2026 to increase by 125 per cent and 234 per cent, respectively, and any meaningful pricing relief is not expected until late 2027. **AI, LEADING FACTOR** AI semiconductors are expected to account for approximately 30 per cent of

total semiconductor revenue in 2026 and will remain the driving force behind the overall industry growth. Hyperscaler investment in AI infrastructure build-outs remains strong with spending expected to increase by more than 50 per cent in 2026, driving demand for AI accelerators, including GPUs and custom non-GPU chips. “Memflation will destroy, or at least delay, non-AI demand into 2028 to varying degrees depending on the application,” said Rajput. “Technology suppliers should prepare for higher prices during the first half of 2026, followed by persistent but moderating price increases throughout the rest of the year. CIOs and IT leaders should be cautious about signing supply agreements with unfavourable pricing terms that extend beyond 2027.”

With \$11.7 b in funding, India tech ranks 4th globally

Sanjana B
Bengaluru



ATTRACTING MONEY. In FY26, India witnessed 13 funding rounds, each of which raised over \$100 million. ISTOCKPHOTO

According to Tracxn's India Tech Annual Funding Report 2026, tech start-ups raised \$11.7 billion in FY26, down 18 per cent from \$14.3 billion in FY25, but a 20 per cent increase from \$9.7 billion in FY24. India ranked as the fourth highest-funded country globally in FY26, behind the US, the UK and China, but ahead of Germany and France. India's tech start-up ecosystem recorded 129 acquisitions in FY26, compared to 151 in FY25, a 15 per cent decline during the year, said the report. The number of acquisitions also saw a 2 per cent drop compared to 132 acquisitions in FY24. Resultsticks stood out with a \$2 billion acquisition by Digix, making it the highest-valued acquisition in FY26, followed by Brahma's \$1.2 billion buy by Polymarket. On the IPO front, India

tech recorded 47 debuts in FY26, up 52 per cent from 31 IPOs in FY25 and a 47 per cent rise from 32 IPOs in FY24. Major IPOs during the year included Lenskart, Groww and Meesho. FY26 saw 6 unicorns coming up — a 50 per cent increase from 4 each in FY25 and in FY24. **EARLY-STAGE GAIN** Seed-stage start-ups raised \$1.3 billion in FY26, marking a 15 per cent decline from \$1.5 billion raised in FY25 and in FY24. Early-stage funding showed strong mo-

mentum, rising to \$4.8 billion in FY26, up 33 per cent from \$3.6 billion raised in FY25, and 37 per cent compared to \$3.5 billion raised in FY24. Late-stage start-ups raised \$5.6 billion in FY26, declining 38 per cent from \$9.2 billion raised in FY25, but a 18 per cent increase compared to \$4.7 billion raised in FY24. Neha Singh, Co-Founder of Tracxn, said, “While overall funding saw moderation, the strong momentum in early-stage investments continued in-

vestor confidence in start-ups building differentiated and scalable solutions. The sustained traction in sectors such as enterprise applications, fintech and retail reflects the growing importance of technology-led transformation across industries. Increased IPO activity and unicorn creation indicate improving maturity within the ecosystem, with companies demonstrating stronger fundamentals, capital efficiency and clearer paths to profitability.” In FY26, India witnessed 13 funding rounds, each of which raised over \$100 million, compared to 23 such rounds in FY25 and 13 in FY24. Large deals were driven primarily by the enterprise infrastructure, enterprise applications and fintech with companies raising notable capital, including Nxtra's \$710 million PE round, Neysa's \$600 million Series B round and Inox Clean Energy's \$344 million Series D funding.

